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Equities Playbook.
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Layoff impact.
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The golden trade is not yet crowded

SAFE HAVEN STILL HOLDS. Ratios, returns favour gold despite recent dip opening a buying window for long-term investors

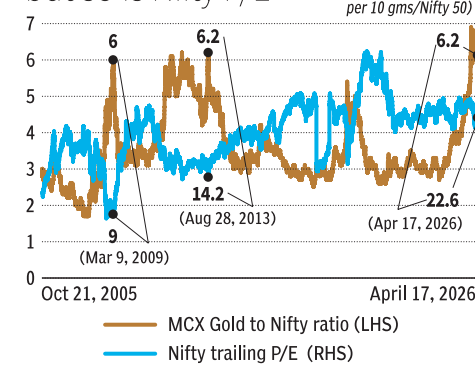
Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Till recently every geopolitical scare, dollar wobble and equity-market stumble pushed gold higher, taking it to record highs of \$5,417 an ounce and ₹1.75 lakh per 10gm by end-January. The subsequent correction — about 11 per cent in dollar terms and 14 per cent in rupee terms — has not materially altered the long-term case. Instead, it offers hesitant investors a more comfortable entry point this Akshaya Tritiya, when many households traditionally buy gold as a symbol of enduring wealth and prosperity.

The macro drivers — monetary debasement, geopolitical instability, fiscal excess, systemic stress and inflation risk — remain intact. For long-term investors, the decline looks more like a pause than a break. While gold bears and equity die-hards invoke the 1980s gold slump, here are 4 reasons why today's fundamentals look different.

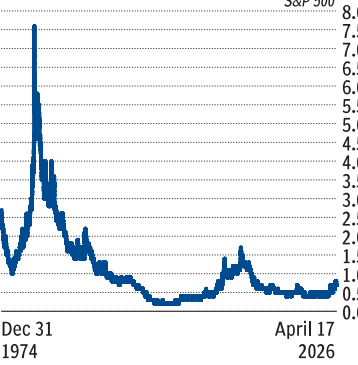
First, the gold-to-S&P 500 ratio — which measures how much of the S&P 500 one ounce of gold can buy — offers a simple gauge of whether bul-

Gold to Nifty ratio is near peaks, but so is Nifty P/E

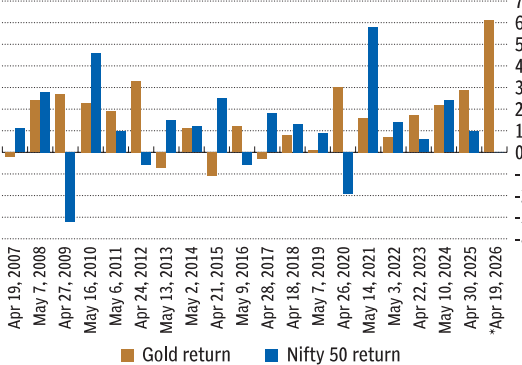


Source: Bloomberg *Upto April 17, 2026 data for this period

Gold to S&P ratio favours yellow metal



Gold outshines Nifty between Akshaya Tritiyas



lion is expensive or cheap relative to equities. At about 0.7 today, the ratio suggests gold is strong, but not historically over-owned even though gold absolute price level may appear expensive.

In the inflation-scarred 1970s, the ratio crossed 2.5 at end-1974, and it exploded to 7.5-7.6 in January 1980 during gold's great blow-off. Even after that peak, it remained around 3.5-4 in parts of 1981.

By contrast, during the post-2000 equity boom and again in the AI-led US stock surge of 2024, the ratio was mostly stuck near 0.4-0.5,

showing how dominant equities had become relative to gold. In relative terms, gold still appears well below the euphoric extremes typical of crisis or inflationary regimes, suggesting room for further outperformance.

CONTEXT MATTERS

Second, gold's recent decline does not signal that the bull case is broken. From the January 28, 2026 peak of \$5,417, the metal fell as much as 19.2 per cent by March 26, before narrowing the drawdown to about 10.8 per cent by April 17.

That is sharp, but gold has

repeatedly absorbed such setbacks. Even in the recent bull phase, drawdowns of about 5.4 per cent in June 2024 and 7.3 per cent in December 2024 did not derail the uptrend. The historical precedent is even starker: in the mid-1970s, gold slumped from \$185 to \$104, a drawdown of more than 44 per cent, yet later went on to its 1980 blow-off top. By that standard, the current setback in 2026 looks less like a broken trade and more like a correction within an ongoing cycle.

Third, the MCX gold-to-Nifty ratio is elevated — but this time the equity backdrop

is very different. In the post-crisis lows of 2009, when the ratio climbed to 6 in March-2009, the Nifty's trailing P/E was just 9.2 times. That mattered: gold was expensive relative to equities, but equities themselves were plainly cheap and stocks almost doubled in next nine months.

Again, in August/September-2013, the ratio hit multi-year high of 6.1 but Nifty P/E was around 14.2 times, a valuation level that helped equities double in the next five years. By contrast, the ratio touched 6.9 on January 29, 2026 with the Nifty still trading at 23.7 times

trailing earnings. And by April 17, the ratio was still around 6.2 even with the Nifty P/E on 22.6 times. So the current MCX gold-Nifty-ratio at close to peak levels, does not provide any convincing comfort that gold will underperform stocks.

STRONG TRACK RECORD

Fourth, history suggests Akshaya Tritiya buyers have little reason to treat gold as a poor cousin to equities. Across 20 comparable one-year holding periods since 2007, gold delivered an average return of 15.9 per cent against 11.8 per cent for the Nifty 50. More im-

portantly, gold protected capital better in difficult years. Its worst periods saw a fall of 11 per cent, against a 32 per cent decline for the Nifty. It outperformed decisively in stress years such as 2009, 2012, 2020 and the latest period (April 30, 2025 to April 17, 2026).

Over the full sample, gold rose from ₹9,372 per 10 grams to ₹1,51,097 — a gain of roughly 16 times. Over the same period, Nifty 50 rose a little over six times.

Even traditionally balanced investors are turning more constructive on gold. Veteran investor Ray Dalio has recently said a well-diversified portfolio should hold roughly 10-15 per cent in gold, a higher weighting than the 7.5 per cent gold slice. He has also argued that gold is unique because, unlike financial assets, it is not someone else's liability.

bl.video

Watch webinar on 'Equities, gold or cash: Where to hide amid the chaos' by **Har Viswanath**, Editor, bl.portfolio

<https://tinyurl.com/blEquitiesWebinarApr18>

Iran closes Strait of Hormuz for ships again; two vessels fired upon

Agencies

Merchant vessels attempting to cross the Strait of Hormuz on Saturday received radio messages from Iran's navy telling them they were not allowed to pass, while two ships reported being hit by gunfire, shipping sources said.

Several commercial vessels tried to transit the Strait after receiving a notice to mariners a day earlier saying passage would be allowed but restricted to lanes Iran deems safe. The incidents were reported in waters between the Qeshm and Larak islands. The vessels turned back without completing the crossing, the sources said.

Hundreds of ships and about 20,000 seafarers remain stranded in the Gulf, waiting to pass through the key waterway, which handles about 20 per cent of global oil and liquefied natural gas flows.

VESSELS TURN BACK

A convoy of 14 India-bound ships carrying crude oil and gas was stopped by the Iranian Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) by firing at two of them while they were transiting the Strait of Hormuz, leading to 13 of the vessels returning to different locations in the Persian Gulf, official sources privy to the development said.

An Indian-flag carrying ship, which was hit by bullets fired by the IRGC while crossing the Hormuz, was carrying crude oil. A window pane was broken, forcing the ship to stop the journey and return.

However, another ship, which was Indian flagged and loaded with crude oil for the Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Ltd, sailed through the Strait and is now heading to India, the sources said.

India summoned Iranian envoy Mohammad Fathali over the firing on vessels by IRGC, authoritative sources said. A strong protest was lodged with the Ambassador, they said.

Govt sets up ₹12,980 cr maritime insurance pool; to cover hull, cargo, P&I and war risks

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

To address insurance constraints faced by shippers amid the West Asia conflict, the government on Sunday announced the creation of a 'Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool' (BMIP), backed by a sovereign guarantee.

The move is expected to reduce the insurance costs for vessels operating on war-affected routes by about 25 per cent immediately.

"The pool will have a sovereign guarantee of ₹12,980 crore to ensure uninterrupted maritime insurance coverage," Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said at a media briefing.

In addition, the pool will have a corpus of ₹930 crore, with contributions from



SAFE HARBOUR. The move is expected to reduce insurance costs for vessels operating on war-affected routes immediately by about 25 per cent

GIC Re (₹400 crore), public sector general insurers (₹200 crore), and the balance from private insurers.

FOR INDIAN NEEDS

"Policies will be issued by member insurers using the pool's combined underwriting capacity of around ₹930 crore," an official statement said.

The pool aims to manage liability insurance domestically, tailored to Indian shipping conditions and regulatory requirements, while building specialised capabilities in marine underwriting, claims management and legal expertise within the country.

The cover will extend to India-flagged vessels, In-

dia-controlled vessels, and those with India as origin or destination.

The scheme will initially run for 10 years, extendable up to 15 years. It is also expected to reduce dependence on foreign insurers, facilitate reciprocal insurance arrangements, and lower foreign exchange outgo on premiums.

The pool will cover a full spectrum of maritime risks, including hull and machinery, cargo, protection and indemnity (P&I), and war risk.

A governing body will be constituted to oversee the pool's formation and operations.

"The sovereign guarantee is aimed at strengthening self-reliance, enhancing sanctions resilience, and ensuring greater sovereign control," the statement added.

Will push for women's reservation; Opposition missed a historic chance: PM

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday insisted that efforts for implementing women's reservation will not stop and vowed to remove all the obstacles.

"Yesterday, we did not have the numbers, but that does not mean we have accepted defeat. Our efforts will not stop. We will have more opportunities in the future. For the dreams of half the population and for the future of the country, we are determined to fulfil this resolve," he said in his address to the nation a day after the Constitution Amendment Bill for implementation of women reservation by hiking the number of total seats failed in the Lok Sabha.

The legislation aimed to expand the strength of the Lok Sabha from 543 seats to



Prime Minister Narendra Modi

816 to operationalise 33 per cent reservation for women ahead of the 2029 general elections. The proposal was linked to a delimitation exercise based on the 2011 Census and included provisions to increase seats in state and Union Territory assemblies.

Launching all-out attack against Opposition parties during his televised address, the Prime Minister said that the Congress, DMK, TMC and the Samajwadi

Party had "committed *bhroon hatya* (female foeticide)" by defeating the Bill. "I felt hurt to see that when the Bill for women's welfare was defeated, parties like Congress and DMK were clapping and thumping desks. What they did was not just noise on the table, it was a blow to the dignity of women," he said.

Modi reminded these parties that a woman may forget everything, but she never forgets her insult. He also said that the Opposition has betrayed the people of their own States as well.

"The DMK had an opportunity, the TMC also had a chance to take the people of Bengal forward, but they too wasted it. The SP also had a chance to reduce its image of being anti-women, but by opposing this, it has crushed the dreams of Lohiaji," the Prime Minister said while accusing the Congress of being an anti-reforms party.

HDFC Bank Q4 net up 9% on rise in other income, lower loan-loss set off

Our Bureau
Mumbai

HDFC Bank reported a 9 per cent year-on-year rise in standalone net profit at ₹19,221 crore for the fourth quarter, up from ₹17,616 crore a year ago, aided by healthy growth in other income and a decline in loan-loss provisions amid improving asset quality.

For FY26, the net profit rose 10.9 per cent to ₹74,670 crore.

The board recommended a final dividend of ₹13 per equity share (face value ₹1), taking the total dividend for FY26 to ₹15.50 per share.

Making a rare appearance on the earnings call following the abrupt resignation of part-time chairman Atanu Chakraborty last

Keki Mistry, currently the interim chairman, is favoured for the role of part-time chairman

month, MD and CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan said the bank's "strength and resilience" were evident in stable and strong deposit flows despite the "unprecedented event" in March.

He added that supportive statements from the Government, the Reserve Bank of India and SEBI helped reassure stakeholders.

On leadership, Jagdishan said both he and Deputy MD Kaizad Bharucha favour Keki Mistry, currently interim chairman, for the role of part-time chairman.

However, the nomination and remuneration committee (NRC) and the board will take a final call.

On Jagdishan's own re-appointment, with his term ending October 26, 2026, Bharucha said the matter is under consideration by the NRC and the board.

Q4 PERFORMANCE

The net interest income rose 3 per cent yoy to ₹33,082 crore (₹32,066 crore), while other income grew 10 per cent to ₹13,199 crore (₹12,028 crore). Loan-loss provisions declined 21 per cent to ₹2,610 crore (₹3,193 crore).

Asset quality improved, with gross NPAs easing to 1.15 per cent of advances as of March-end 2026, from 1.33 per cent a year earlier. Net NPAs declined to 0.38 per cent from 0.43 per cent.

ICICI Bank reports 8.5% jump in Q4 profit on strong loan growth, dip in provisions

Our Bureau
Mumbai

ICICI Bank reported an 8.5 per cent increase in the net profit for the March, fourth, quarter of FY26, supported by stable margins, broad-based loan growth and lower provisions.

The private lender's net profit for the fourth quarter came in at ₹13,701.7 crore, while the net interest income was 8.4 per cent higher on year at ₹22,979 crore.

Core operating profit grew 5.1 per cent on year to ₹18,305 crore reflecting continued strength in the bank's core lending and fee businesses, while the net interest margin was stable at 4.32 per cent, though Executive Director Sandeep

Q4 scorecard

	Q4 FY25 (₹ crore)	Q4 FY26 (₹ crore)
Net profit	12,629.6	13,701.7
Net interest income	21,193.0	22,979.0
NIM (%)	4.3	

Batra indicated that NIM would have limited upside ahead.

The bank's asset quality strengthened during the quarter, with provisions falling steeply to ₹96 crore from ₹890.7 crore in the year ago period, aided by higher recoveries and write-backs. Both net NPA and gross NPA ratios saw a decline at the end of March from December-end levels.

The bank said it continued to hold a contingency buffer of ₹13,100 crore. There was a treasury loss of ₹106 crore in the quarter

compared to loss of ₹157 crore in Q3 and gain of ₹239 crore in Q4 of FY25.

LOANS AND DEPOSITS

Loan growth remained healthy at about 15.8 per cent year-on-year to ₹15.5 lakh crore, driven by momentum across segments including business banking, retail mortgages and rural portfolios.

However, deposit growth lagged at around 11-12 per cent, creating a gap with credit expansion. The bank said this divergence is manageable, noting that "de-

posit and credit growth have to move in tandem over time." At the end of March, deposits were at ₹17.9 lakh crore, with average current and savings account (CASA) deposits up by 11.3 per cent on-year and 2.7 per cent sequentially in the quarter.

The board declared a dividend of ₹12 per share.

GROWTH OUTLOOK

The bank was monitoring the developments in West Asia, but Batra said that it was too early to assess the impact, "where forecast validity is not even a day at this point."

The bank also approved annual renewal of fund raising limits via issue of debt securities in the domestic markets up to ₹25,000 crore and up to \$1.5 billion in the overseas markets.

War, volatility and stock markets

EQUITIES PLAYBOOK. With structural shifts playing out, investors should assess the situation before gearing up for bargain hunting

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

The last five years in Indian equities can be seen in two distinct phases. In the first three-and-a-half years, Nifty 50 raced at a brisk pace of 18.7 per cent annual CAGR till September 2024. The Nifty 50 one-year forward PE gained 2 whole points to trade at 21 times in September 2024, compared to 19 times in April 2021. The phenomenal spell in the equity market may have lent an air of invincibility, which the investors have been reluctant to shed now. In the last one-and-a-half years, a few attempts to breach the peak have been undone. First, the US president election raised fears of protectionism starting from mid-2024. This manifested, but with sharper than expected, tariff announcements during the course of 2025. This was countered by multiple trade agreements including the EU, the UK and finally with the US in early 2026. Soon after, the US-Iran conflict emerged, driving Brent Crude up 60 per cent year to date (YTD) and equity values down.

As shown in the table, most of the sectoral indices have declined YTD, consequently. The Nifty 50 index is down 7 per cent YTD and the index one-year forward PE is down 11 per cent during the period. The highest impact has been on the NSE IT, NSE Real estate and NSE FMCG indices. But, on the other hand, NSE Metals, BSE Capital Goods and NSE Energy index have gained in the year. While 60 per cent of Nifty 500 stocks have declined YTD, optimism can be found in the remaining 40 per cent.

Fundamental investors are now faced with a crucial task of positioning himself/herself for the next five years. Opportunities might be emerging, but uncertainty and fear also abound. The way things are trending now appears like it is now time for the value investor to gradually take over the reins from the growth investor as value buckets are emerging again after phenomenal rally till September 2024 as shown in the table.

On December 31, 2020, 52 per cent of Nifty 50 stocks were reasonably valued (one-year forward PE of less than 20 times). This shrunk to 38 per cent on September 2024 and further down to 33 per cent in January 2026, as investors got optimistic on an upcoming trade deal. The proportion of stocks that are reasonably valued has increased to 42 per cent now, closer to pre-Covid levels. The same phenomenon can be observed in Nifty 500 and Nifty SmallCap 250 index when measured with a cap of 30 times PE for reasonably-valued stocks.

However, it is important to note here that the word 'reasonably valued' is used in a relative context, given the higher valuations that markets have got accustomed to in the last five years. If one were to compare with valuations in the earlier decade, these many not be as reasonable as we deem it now.

Given that structural shifts are playing out investors should assess the situation at this point before gearing up for bargain hunting.

DARK CLOUDS

Investors should establish a medium-term baseline assumption. This should incorporate the current macroeconomic conditions which are underlining the bearish sentiment. This is to insulate against further shocks and to build a resilient portfolio. We emphasise inflation, limited fiscal and monetary space, and individual company limitations as the baseline assumptions.

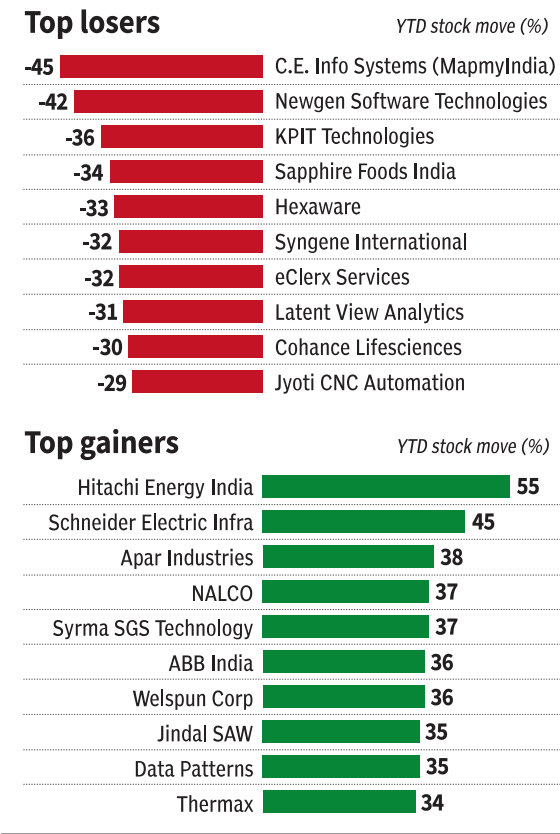
The short-term spikes and volatility of crude oil notwithstanding, investors will have to incorporate higher crude prices for the medium term, which should imply higher inflation even if the conflict nears a resolution immediately. The RBI MPC meet also pointed to 4.6 per cent inflation in FY27 compared to 2.1 per cent in FY26. Crude prices, which were at \$60 per barrel (Brent crude) on January 1, 2026, nearly doubled to a peak of \$118 at the end of March, before settling at \$90 per barrel now.

Even on conflict resolution in the near or distant future, a risk premium will be added by the buyers of crude oil themselves in view of the heightened volatility and the need to insulate against any aftershocks. Apart from this, the logistics, security and insurance of transportation — and not even considering the toll tax under geopolitical discussions — will restrict Brent crude returning to \$60 per barrel any time soon. Various research houses are working with \$75-80 per barrel on normalisation, which is 30 per cent higher than the base line.

This should imply high inflation in the economy which will gradually take hold. In the form of freight movement, supply chain scarcities, food inflation and expectation of inflation more than the inflation itself. This leads to higher prices, as customers and enterprises pull forward purchase in anticipation of higher costs later. If commodities (base and ferrous metals), also set up on an inflationary path (as has been the case post-Covid), the inflationary cycle will last longer even in an optimistic case.

Consequently, monetary and fiscal space will be limited. Against a possible rate cut expectation this year, the RBI may consider a rate hike. This could be in response to either domestic inflation or in response to concurrent rate hikes by other central banks and defend the rupee against the dollar. In the fiscal space, the government already announced GST rate cuts and income tax rationalisation last year and announced a cut in excise duties to combat oil prices. This should limit the spending power of the government impacting the aggregate demand for Indian corporate.

Finally, company-specific limitations have to be analysed. At a strategic level, companies will pause or slow down any aggressive expansion plans. Corporate capex, which has been recovering, will likely be on hold again and this will have a trickle-down effect. Apart from Pharma, IT, Textiles and Gems, many other sectors were finding their stride in export markets. Including Autos, Capital goods, EMS and even FMCG. These sectors are more reliant on Latin American, West Asian and African markets, which are more susceptible to the macro instability than developed markets. The volatile outlook will im-



pact the valuations that are conditional to earnings growth driven by expansion plans.

There certainly can be an upside risk to the conservative assumptions, but a prudent investor should work with the baseline assumption to insulate their portfolio. Higher inflation, limited fiscal and monetary space, and tentative corporate outlook.

SEARCHING FOR SILVER LININGS

To sort out the eventual silver lining, we start with sectors that are relatively insulated from the oil shock or the inflation, including Pharma, Hospitals and IT.

IT

IT sector's direct impact could be limited to clients from West Asia, which is a smaller proportion of the revenues. But the sector has a bigger overhang to deal with. The larger issue of AI disruption is at an inflection point. Indian IT's role at such juncture, where value delivery from the AI build-up will be emphasised, will be a litmus test for the industry. The sector participation and the revenue potential will be the key monitorable. IT bellwether TCS continued to report weak constant currency revenue growth in Q4FY26 and while it expects FY27 to be better, that is no solace given the over 2 per cent decline in constant currency growth in FY26.

Pharma and Healthcare

Pharma sector does rely on chemical precursors, but the margin impact should be limited. The sector is on the verge of launching or has launched in many cases (starting with Dr. Reddy's) generic semaglutide for diabetes and weight loss. Pending regulatory clearance, the sector will eye Indian and several other markets including West Asian markets in the current fiscal year as pharmaceutical reach will not be impeded by the conflict. The sector constituents can be analysed on individual strength; earlier, we had recommended investors accumulate Caplin Point, and hold Zydus Lifesciences. Similarly, hospital stocks should not be affected by

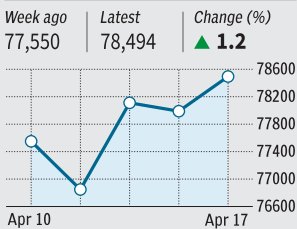
WISE WORDS.

“You seldom get good long-term advice: an efficient capitalist enterprise will feel it must feed you what you want to hear and stay with the pack

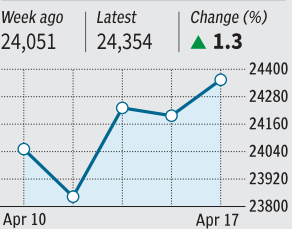
JEREMY GRANTHAM
Market veteran

MARKET ACTION.

SENSEX



NIFTY



Latam, West Asia and Africa along with currency fluctuation, which are the major markets, will be volatile. Maruti Suzuki and Hyundai India stock prices have declined 20 per cent YTD. The two companies with strong parentage should weather any supply-chain issues better than peers.

Power Generation

India's installed power capacity at 520 GW in January 2026 is on its way to reach the projected capacity of around 900 GW by 2031. Of this, close to 500 GW is to be sourced from renewables. In the current context of fuel shortage overhang, the targets of installed power and renewable proportion will be further strengthened. This should benefit power generation (NTPC), power transmission (Power Grid) or even power financing companies (REC) for a multi-year growth outlook.

SECTORS TO BE MONITORED

We recommend investors proceed with caution in the sectors of Capital Goods, Consumer Durables, FMCG, Metals, and Oil and Gas.

Capital Goods

The two segments of Capital Goods sector — industrial and power generation machinery — can diverge on expected growth. The sector has positively rerated last year on the tailwinds of revival in industrial capex, which is adding to the valuation risk.

Power demand is strong and expected to remain strong, including renewable additions. Hitachi Energy, GE Vernova and CG Power that supply machinery to the power sector can ride the wave. With valuations at a high, investors need to wait for better valuations.

The industrial segment of Capital Goods, also at high valuations, has benefitted from the modest revival in capex growth last year. As mentioned, the reinvigorated investment cycle may be under pause or consideration till clarity on global demand outlook emerges. This can impact Capital Goods, especially since they are trading with expectations of continued growth.

Consumer Durables

The Consumer Durables sector is facing weak sales momentum, as evidenced even in Q3FY26 results, which despite GST revision acts as a tailwind for the sector. Compared to last year's late Summer, an early Summer in India this year should support room air conditioner (RAC) sales on a weak base of last year. LG Electronics has reported strong growth in most segments, including RACs in Q4FY26 sales.

But full-capacity manufacturing has been impacted on account of LPG shortages in March-April, and more clarity will emerge in Q4FY26 results earnings call in the next few weeks. Higher commodity costs will dent FY27 margin outlook and so will inflation. But with a strong Summer and weak base in FY26, the sector is expected to post good topline growth in low double-digits. Investors need to monitor whether it delivers on that.

FMCG

FMCG valuations continued to be rangebound in FY26 owing to lower secular growth that began

from the last bout of inflation in FY22-23 period. Volume and price growth were stabilising in H2FY26 at low to mid single-digits. But the sector will be further aggravated by inflationary concerns in the current times, and the sector witnessed the sharpest drop in valuation YTD. Crude derivatives including packaging, logistics, dollar imports, and food price inflation are likely to impact margins or revenue growth again in FY27.

Metals

Domestic steel prices, after a four-year hiatus, have now reported increasing prices. The safeguard duty, restricting cheaper imports enacted last year, has trickled into prices. The primary raw materials, on the other hand, iron ore and, more importantly, coking coal are expected to rise. Prior to the conflict as well, the commodities were on the cusp of an inflationary path after the significant decline in input materials, primarily the coking coal price from \$650 in 2021 to less than \$200 in Q3FY26.

With commodity costs expected to rally post the conflict, these prices can escalate impacting steel companies. The companies are better placed to absorb the costs with higher steel prices and operating leverage from expanded capacities. Despite the tailwinds from improved pricing, the sector outlook may be restrictive owing to higher valuations and uncertain infra spending outlook.

Oil and Gas

The segment consists of oil marketing companies (OMCs) and refineries. The refineries, led by Reliance Industries, should benefit from improved gross refining margins in the short term, but this too faces challenges from the government imposing tax on diesel exports, similar to a windfall tax. The OMC segment, on the other hand, will face significant losses from rising crude, as the retail prices have not changed. Any eventual change in prices may be staggered and small, leaving the companies in a loss. As mentioned in the base case, the risk premium will be added to crude prices impacting OMCs for a longer time. The ratio of refining to marketing is the most beneficial for Reliance Industries and unfavourable for HPCL, and should impact the other stocks based on a similar split of refining versus marketing. For a deeper understanding of the sector, check out our detailed Big Story (published in out *bl.portfolio* edition dated March 15, 2026.

TAKEAWAY

As explained above, given the uncertainties and baseline assumptions, investors should assess the situation at this point before gearing up for bargain hunting. The sectoral highlights above reflect a top-down approach. At the same time, as explained in the article in *bl.portfolio* edition dated April 12, 2026, The Sector Call Illusion, ultimately what matters is which stock the investor is buying and not the sector. A good bottom-up approach, by getting into the valuation and specific opportunities and risks of stocks, must be considered before buying stocks. The current conditions reflect a situation where investors can nibble strongly, but definitely not go all in.



Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

The US–Iran military escalation triggered a sharp risk-off phase across global markets, with crude oil prices surging, bond yields hardening, and concerns around global growth intensifying. Indian equities were no exception. Between February 28, 2026 and April 17, 2026, the Nifty 500 fell sharply during the period before recouping most of the losses, ending only 1.3 per cent lower. But beneath the headline index, the factor strategies showed a clear divergence. These are rule-based portfolios built around specific stock traits such as value, quality, momentum, alpha or low volatility. The quality factor emerged as the outperformer, while the low volatility factor, typically viewed as defensive, lagged the most.

To understand how these strategies behaved during the recent turmoil, we analysed the Nifty500 Value 50, Nifty 500 Low Volatility 50, Nifty500 Quality 50, Nifty500 Momentum 50, and Nifty Alpha 50 indices based on total return performance. Following the onset of the conflict, markets saw a sharp drawdown, with indices bottoming out on March 30. The Nifty 500 fell 11.3 per cent during this phase. The quality index proved relatively resilient, declining the least at 8 per cent, while momentum and alpha saw the steepest falls of 12.2 per cent. Low volatility and value declined 10 per cent and 11 per cent, respectively.

As sentiment improved, markets staged a recovery. Between February 28 and April 17, during the conflict period, the quality index topped the returns chart with a gain of 7.1 per cent, comfortably outperforming the Nifty 500, which remained down 1.3 per cent. In contrast, low volatility (-3 per cent) and value (-1.5 per cent) lagged even the broader market, while momentum (-0.3 per cent) and alpha (0.8 per cent) managed to contain losses.

In India, around 117 factor-based funds, managing nearly ₹51,000 crore as of March 2026, deploy rule-based strategies across momentum, alpha, low volatility, quality, and value. These frameworks aim to capture distinct drivers of returns in a transparent and cost-efficient manner.

QUALITY
The quality factor outper-

FACTOR FRAGILITY

- Momentum investing: sudden shocks break trends
- Low volatility: resilient in slowdowns, weak in inflation shocks
- Value investing: sector positioning drive underperformance

formed during the ongoing conflict, driven by its tilt toward companies with strong balance sheets, high return ratios, and stable earnings. Its sector mix, including private-sector financials, IT, consumer businesses, and select pharma, provided resilience in a risk-off environment. Parts of the portfolio also benefitted from favourable market dynamics. Capital market-linked stocks such as Angel One, BSE and Anand Rathi Wealth surged 38 per cent, 31 per cent, and 20 per cent, respectively during the period between February 27 and April 17. Metals and mining names, including National Aluminium (up 24 per cent) and NMDC (up 10 per cent) gained.

Exposure to defence and industrial themes added further support. Stocks such as ABB India, Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders, and Zen Technologies rose 16–19 per cent during the period, driven by expectations of better earnings growth on possible higher defence spending. These gains helped offset weakness in consumption-oriented names such as Britannia and Colgate-Palmolive, which fell 5 per cent and 7 per cent, respectively, amid cost pressures and subdued demand. Additionally, select IT and pharma names, including Persistent Systems and Natco Pharma, delivered notable gains.

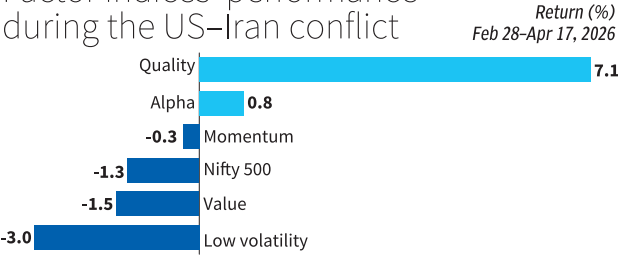
In hindsight, this positioning may have enabled the quality index to provide both downside protection and modest positive returns.

LOWVOLATILITY
The most notable underperformance came from the Nifty 500 Low Volatility 50 index, which declined by 3 per cent. This outcome highlights that not all defensive factors behave similarly across different types of crises. Low volatility strategies typically select stocks with stable price movements based on historical standard deviation, aiming to limit drawdowns and improve risk-adjust-

Winners & losers of war stress test

MARKET DIVIDE. In factor investing, quality leads, alpha, momentum hold up as value and low volatility lag

Factor indices’ performance during the US–Iran conflict



Top gainers and losers by factor exposure

Stock name	Factor exposure	Return (%) Feb 28-Apr 17 2026
Top 10 wealth creators		
Adani Power	Alpha	42.0
Angel One	Quality	38.0
BSE	Alpha, Momentum, Quality	31.0
GMDC	Momentum	29.4
Suzlon Energy	Quality	24.0
National Aluminium Company	Alpha, Value, Quality	23.7
Radico Khaitan	Alpha, Momentum	20.3
Anand Rathi Wealth	Momentum	20.0
Reliance Power	Value	19.6
Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC	Quality	19.5

Top 10 wealth destroyers

Indian Oil Corporation	Value, Low volatility	-22.2
M&M Financial Services	Momentum	-20.0
BPCL	Value	-19.0
Ashok Leyland	Alpha	-18.5
Dabur India	Low volatility	-18.1
Redington	Value, Alpha	-16.3
Bank Of India	Value	-15.9
Petronet LNG	Value	-15.5
HPCL	Value	-15.5
Karur Vysya Bank	Alpha, Momentum, Value	-14.9

Returns are absolute. Value: Nifty500 Value 50 Index; Low Volatility: Nifty 500 Low Volatility 50 Index; Quality: Nifty500 Quality 50 Index; Momentum: Nifty500 Momentum 50 Index; Alpha: Nifty Alpha 50 Index – are considered. Total return index (TRI) variant is considered Source: ACEMF

ted returns. However, they often carry higher exposure to defensive sectors such as utilities and consumer staples. Utilities are particularly vulnerable to rising yields, as seen during the conflict period, while staples can be hurt when inflation and input costs rise.

Large FMCG names such as Dabur, Colgate-Palmolive, and Godrej Consumer Products saw steep corrections of 7–15 per cent. Insurance and financial stocks also declined as bond yields hardened and growth concerns intensified. ICICI Prudential Life Insurance, HDFC Life Insurance, and SBI Cards and Payment Services fell in the 10–14 per cent range. Notably, the index had limited exposure to metals, defence, capital market infrastructure, and energy. These are the sectors that drew investor interest during the geopolitical escalation. While select stocks such as Page Industries, Tata Power, and Tech Mahindra gained 11–18 per cent, their weights were

insufficient to offset broader losses.

This underperformance suggests that low volatility strategies may fare better in growth slowdowns or earnings-led corrections, but can struggle in inflationary or supply-shock-driven environments.

MOMENTUM
Momentum and alpha factors, though negative, showed relative outperformance compared to the broader market. The alpha index benefitted from a few standout performers, most notably Adani Power that gained 42 per cent. Exchange and commodity-linked plays such as BSE and MCX, along with metals like National Aluminium, also contributed positively.

However, these gains were offset by substantial losses in PSU banks, auto majors, and select financial stocks, which form a significant part of the alpha basket. Stocks such as Ashok Leyland (-17 per cent), Bank of India (-16 per cent), Karur

Vysya Bank (-15 per cent), and Eicher Motors (-10 per cent) were a drag on performance.

Momentum strategies, which chase recent outperformers, drew some support from exposure to capital markets and select pharma, capital goods, and energy names. However, names such as Bajaj Finance, Cholamandalam Investment Finance, and Mahindra Finance recorded steep declines of 9–20 per cent. Auto stocks, which had strong prior momentum, also corrected sharply. Overall, the episode highlights a key limitation of momentum investing: during sudden external shocks, past trends can break down quickly, exposing these strategies to drawdowns.

VALUE

The Nifty 500 Value 50 index, which tracks relatively undervalued stocks, is often seen as better placed in market corrections. Yet, it fell 1.5 per cent and lagged the Nifty 500. Top gainers included National Aluminium, Reliance Power, Hindalco Industries, and NMDC, which delivered gains of 10–24 per cent. However, Indian Oil, BPCL, and HPCL declined sharply by 16–22 per cent as rising crude prices stoked concerns over their marketing margins. Value indices also carry significant weights in PSU banks. Stocks such as Bank of Baroda, Punjab National Bank, SBI, and Bank of India posted double-digit losses of up to 16 per cent. Thus, losses in OMCs and PSBs more than offset the gains in metals, causing the index to lag.

TAKEAWAY

The US–Iran conflict offered a live stress test for factor strategies, revealing how differently they behave under geopolitical and inflationary shocks.

Quality emerged as the clear winner, rewarding investors with both downside protection and positive returns. Momentum and alpha, while negative, managed to contain losses better than the broader market, aided by select sector tailwinds. Low volatility was a disappointment, showing that a defensive tag does not always mean safety in such crises. Value, too, underwhelmed, showing that lower valuations alone do not guarantee resilience in every correction. The lesson for investors is that they should evaluate factor strategies not just on historical risk metrics, but also on their underlying sector composition and macro sensitivity before investing.

Prediction markets ‘as trading scales’

GLOBAL VIEW. Citadel Securities monitoring fast-moving sector and evaluating when to enter hottest new derivatives space

Bloomberg

Ken Griffin’s market-making giant Citadel Securities is monitoring the fast-moving prediction-markets industry as it evaluates when to enter one of the hottest new derivatives spaces. Citadel Securities isn’t involved in trading event contracts currently, but the firm is “absolutely, keeping an eye on developments in the market,” President Jim Esposito said Thursday at the Semafor World Economy conference.

GREATER TRACTION

The entry of players such as Citadel Securities would indicate that prediction markets are gaining greater traction in the finance industry even as legal uncertainties around the business linger and institutional investors stay mostly on the sidelines. Susquehanna International Group and Jump Trading are among Citadel Securities’ peers that have entered the space.

“We’re not there yet. There is not that much liquidity,” Es-

● **WHAT’S ON OFFER**

Prediction-market exchanges including Kalshi and Polymarket offer contracts that allow users to bet on elections, sports and other events

posito said. But prediction markets are likely “to ramp and scale,” he said, and “as it does, will we continue to look at it and potentially get involved.”

Esposito said he sees a purpose for certain event contracts to be used, for both retail and institutional traders who are looking for protections in their investment portfolios.

The contracts can be used as a form of protection around real-world, market-moving events such as elections, he said.

“Having a clean and distinct way to hedge certain risks, there is a good use case and industrial logic to it,” Esposito said.

Prediction market exchanges including Kalshi Inc and Polymarket offer contracts that allow users to bet on elections,



sports and other events. Unlike a sports book, which takes the other side of every bet from customers, the firms offer a venue where people on both sides of trades can meet, similar to the way that stock and derivatives exchanges work.

Citadel Securities isn’t looking at sport contracts, Esposito

said. He sees other types of event contracts as “interesting” to the market-maker, particularly if they are growing in popularity with retail investors.

Susquehanna, the trading business run by former professional gambler Jeff Yass, was the first financial trading firm to publicly discuss its role as a mar-

ket-maker in prediction markets. It has a unit that specialises in sports betting, based in Dublin. Chicago-based proprietary-trading firm Jump Trading also became active on prediction markets such as Kalshi, Bloomberg News reported.

RETAIL TRADING

Citadel Securities may enter prediction markets faster if there is more activity and interest from the retail-trading community, Esposito said.

Should more brokerage firms, such as Charles Schwab Corp, join Robinhood Markets Inc in offering event contracts to retail investors, that might “pull” the market-maker in, he said.

Schwab is likely to launch prediction markets tied to financial events, Chief Executive Officer Rick Wurster said Thursday, giving no timeline for the addition.

Esposito also said he met recently with Kalshi co-founder Tarek Mansour.

“We have built a good relationship,” he said, “and I am following his and other business models quite closely at the moment.”

ALERTS.

SBI CRISIL-IBX Financial Services 9-12 Months Debt Index

SBI CRISIL-IBX Financial Services 9-12 Months Debt Index Fund is an open-ended Constant Maturity Index Fund tracking the CRISIL-IBX Financial Services 9-12 Months Debt Index with a relatively low-interest rate risk and relatively low credit risk. The NFO closes on April 20. The entry load and exit load are nil. The minimum subscription amount is ₹5,000 and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter.

The performance will be benchmarked against CRISIL-IBX Financial Services 9-12 Months Debt Index; its fund manager is Rajeev Radhakrishnan. The objective is to provide returns that closely correspond to total returns of the securities represented by the underlying index.

Groww MF launches Arbitrage Fund

Groww Arbitrage Fund is an open-ended equity scheme investing in arbitrage opportunities. The NFO closes on April 22. The entry load is not applicable and exit load is nil. The minimum subscription amount is ₹500 and in multiples of ₹1 thereafter for purchase and switch-in. The performance will be benchmarked with Nifty 50 Arbitrage TRI; its fund managers are Paras Matalia, Shashi Kumar and Wilfred Gonsalves. The objective is to generate long-term growth of capital by predominantly investing in arbitrage opportunities between cash and derivative markets, as well as within the derivative segment, complemented by investments in debt securities and money market instruments.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

	NAV (₹) as on April 17	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
ETF				
Motilal Nasdaq 100 ETF	242	287	13	4,261
Mirae NYSE FANG+ ETF	146	176	12	322
Motilal Nasdaq Q50 ETF	104	123	10	352
Groww Nifty Cap Market ETF	11	11	9	3,067
Groww BSE Power ETF	12	12	9	15,543
Mirae Asset S&P 500 Top 50	62	74	8	545
Groww Nifty Railways ETF	33	33	8	1,504
GOLD ETFs				
Invesco India Gold ETF	13,099	13,125	2	1
Baroda BNPP Gold ETF	146	146	2	61
Mirae Asset Gold ETF	146	147	2	4,346

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on April 17, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on April 17	Returns (% CAGR)				Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year		
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS						
ICICI Pru Pension Fund	74	16	14	14	25,125	
Kotak Pension Fund	68	16	14	14	4,151	
UTI Pension Fund	72	16	14	14	4,850	
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS						
LIC Pension Fund	31	7	6	8	8,421	
SBI Pension Fund	41	7	6	8	27,519	
UTI Pension Fund	37	7	6	8	4,004	
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS						
HDFC Pension Fund	30	8	7	8	33,108	
ICICI Pru Pension Fund	45	8	7	8	13,143	
SBI Pension Fund	46	8	7	8	14,868	
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS						
ICICI Pru Pension Fund	58	16	14	14	700	
Kotak Pension Fund	60	16	14	14	202	
HDFC Pension Fund	47	15	14	14	1,673	

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on April 17, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	250	-5.0	16.2	18.5
ICICI Pru	Largecap	768	-1.3	17.7	16.3
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	-1.5	16.6	14.0
Renaissance Investment Managers	Opportunities Portfolio	NA	-8.2	11.7	13.6
MULTI CAP					
Shepherd's Hill Financial Advisors	Value Magno	108	11.2	29.8	23.7
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	106	2.0	28.4	23.6
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	971	8.5	24.2	22.6
Buoyant Capital	Opportunities	8,689	6.0	21.0	22.0
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	5,833	-2.6	31.5	21.6
Negen Capital Services	Special Situ & Tech Strategy	1,133	-2.1	24.3	21.4
MID-CAP					
Master Portfolio Services	Master Trust India Growth	312	2.0	13.0	15.9
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	-5.3	13.3	15.9
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	-4.1	13.6	15.5
Nippon Life India Asset Mgmt	Emerging India	NA	0.1	17.4	14.1
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	3,788	43.5	45.5	44.6
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	712	-14.0	17.7	33.6
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,046	-19.5	28.3	22.9
Accuracap	Dynamo	NA	-4.4	25.6	21.0

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on March 31, 2026

On the right track for growth

IPO WATCH. Citius appears to be a reasonably priced road InvIT with a mix of yield and some visible growth levers

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

Citius TransNet’s ₹1,105-crore IPO is the latest road InvIT to hit the capital market. The offer closes on April 21, and has been subscribed 69 per cent so far.

The proceeds, of up to ₹1,000 crore, are proposed to be used for the partial or full acquisition of securities of one entity and certain identified projects. Essentially, these will be used to buy or redeem sponsor-held securities in certain SPVs, and should not be viewed as a simple deleveraging exercise. Consequently, Citius will get control of an initial portfolio comprising seven toll-road assets and three annuity-road assets.

Epic TransNet Infrastructure, the sponsor, along with certain sponsor-group entities, will hold at least 15 per cent of Citius’ units on a post-issue basis. The trust is also supported by the wider EAAA India Alternatives platform, which provides future acquisition pipeline for the InvIT.

There is no retail investor quota in the IPO and these investors have to bid in the non-institutional window (25 per cent quota), with minimum amount of bid at ₹14,850-15,000. At the upper end of the ₹99-100 per unit price band, the Citius issue implies a post-issue m-cap of ₹6,100 crore.

The initial portfolio of 10 road assets together span 3,406.7 lane-km. It is skewed towards toll roads (88 per cent of 9MFY26 revenue). Citius (see table) offers higher growth potential through traffic-linked toll collections, but also leaves the trust more exposed to economic activity.

It also has a Right of First Offer (ROFO) for the acquisition of 11 hybrid annuity model (HAM) assets (2,366.81 lane-km), held/to be acquired by the sponsor EAAA platform.

Using Citius’ enterprise value (EV), provided by the valuer, of ₹10,494 crore for the initial portfolio and projected FY27 EBITDA of about ₹1,865 crore,

Asset-wise financial projections for initial portfolio assets (FY27 – FY31)

Asset name	Concession ends	Revenue (₹ cr)					EBITDA %				
		FY27	FY28	FY29	FY30	FY31	FY27	FY28	FY29	FY30	FY31
AMTPL (Base)	June 4, 2033	485.0	523.2	559.4	598.5	640.6	63	62	61	60	59
DTPL	April 6, 2044	285.6	313.5	343.4	375.6	409.3	86	87	87	88	88
PECPL	Jan 31, 2027	111.0	-	-	-	-	87	-	-	-	-
RVTPPL	Feb 20, 2030	297.4	327.8	363.7	356.5	-	61	60	59	59	-
SBGTPL	Nov 12, 2034	335.3	370.0	405.6	446.1	489.4	89	90	90	90	91
SRTPPL	Dec 6, 2040	324.2	354.9	386.5	420.9	459.8	84	84	84	84	85
TEL	Sep 14, 2036	181.9	202.7	221.5	240.9	262.6	88	89	89	90	90
Dibang	Nov 12, 2030	79.4	79.4	79.4	79.4	79.4	89.3	88.8	88.3	87.5	88.2
Dhola	Feb 28, 2030	111.8	111.8	111.8	111.8	-	91.8	91.4	90.9	91.1	-
JSEL	Jan 11, 2031	145.0	145.0	145.0	145.0	145.0	89.4	89	88.6	88	87.7
Total		2,356.6	2,428.3	2,616.3	2,774.7	2,486.1	79.1	78.5	78	78.2	80.8

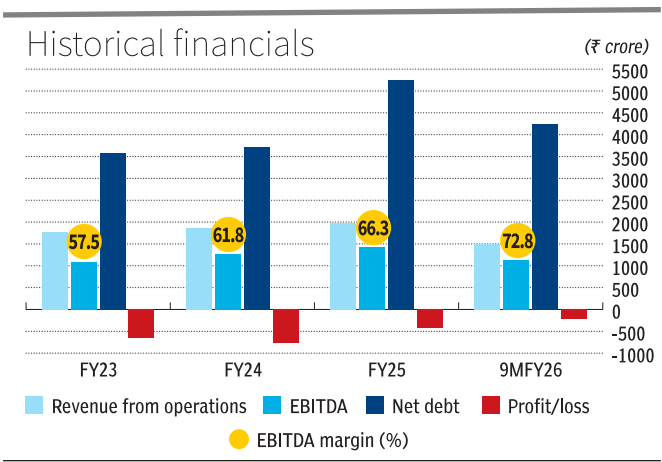
EBITDA: Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation and Amortization NHAI: National Highways Authority of India MoRTH: Ministry of Road Transport & Highways. Data source: Fair Enterprise Valuation (December 31, 2025) report by valuer & bl.portfolio calculations
AMTPL (Base): The extreme drop in FCF for FY29 is due to a scheduled Major Maintenance (MMR) cash outlay. Figures for PECPL (FY27) and RVTPPL (FY30) reflect partial years as their concessions expire during those fiscal years. EBITDA for Dhola, Dibang, and JSEL is calculated as the annual sum of Total Cash Inflow minus O&M Expense. For Dhola, Dibang, and JSEL, the figures are estimates aggregated from their respective semi-annual receipt projections

the implied forward EV/EBITDA (including contribution from HAM assets) works out to roughly 5.6 times. This is at the lower end of some peer road InvITs (6x-11x).

The company’s EV (m-cap+ net debt) comes to ₹10,347 crore and that is at marginal discount to the valuer’s number.

In short, Citius looks better than a plain-vanilla yield play at a reasonable valuation. But at the same time, this cannot be viewed as a stock you invest in for high compounding. InvITs are mandated to distribute 90 per cent of their net distributable cashflows as dividends to investors. So InvITs are like quasi-equity quasi-debt instruments. Hence, this is for investors who want regular income (from annual net distributable cash flows) with modest capital appreciation over the long term (four-five years).

The long horizon is required because InvIT valuations can also come under pressure when rates rise, as their yields look less attractive against fixed-income options. With the domestic easing cycle largely mature, scope for further yield-led rerating may be limited. Returns will depend on asset perform-



Source: RHP

ance, leverage, refinancing costs and distribution growth.

WHAT WORKS

Toll assets earn from user toll collections. Annuity assets earn fixed payments from the authority. The key thing to track is cash generation. Since an InvIT must distribute most of its cash flow, future growth depends on acquiring new assets through fresh debt or equity. An InvIT’s growth model rests on four pillars: Yield from mature cash-generating assets, expansion through fresh debt or equity, sponsor-led asset acquisitions

and periodic replenishment of concessions. Without new assets, cash flows will decline as road concessions run off.

The Citius portfolio has operating depth. The project SPVs have a strong operational history. Mature roads tend to have more predictable traffic and cost behaviour. Toll revenues also have an embedded inflation cushion. The fee rules specify that applicable toll rates rise by 3 per cent annually along with an adjustment linked to changes in WPI. That provides some natural tariff support over time.

The identified ROFO assets

add another source of optional-ity. The 11 HAM assets together generated nearly ₹890 crore of annuity in FY25. If acquired at sensible valuations and with prudent funding, they could reduce the trust’s dependence on toll traffic and extend the cash-flow runway. Several of these ROFO assets are still early in their annuity lives.

Citius’ operating track record is also improving. Revenue has risen steadily from FY23 to 9MFY26, while EBITDA margin has expanded to 72.8 per cent in 9MFY26. At an implied m-cap of ₹6,100 crore, the portfolio is estimated to generate an average enterprise free cash flow yield of about 11 per cent (average FCF of about ₹1,200 crore) over the next five years (FY27-31). The investor distribution yield to unitholders would likely fall into a lower, more sustainable range. Some privately-sponsored road InvITs are currently offering 8-9 per cent yield (post-tax).

FACTORS TO CONSIDER

The portfolio is not perpetual. Some assets have short residual concession lives (see table). So, investors cannot extrapolate current cash flows indefinitely.

There is also some revenue concentration. The two Gujarat assets—Ahmedabad-Maliya Tollway (AMTPL) and Samkhiali Bhachau Gandhidham (SBGTPL)—together account for more than one-third of revenue, while the top five stretches contribute over 73 per cent of projected FY27 revenue.

Maintenance is another key variable. Roads require periodic major maintenance and repairs. Instead, they create spikes that can temporarily depress free cash flow and, distributions. AMTPL (base) sees free cash flow dropping sharply in FY29.

Debt is another factor. Net debt stood at ₹4,247 crore (9MFY26), and net debt to FY25 EBITDA is about 3.7 times. Also, investors should not assume that most of EBITDA can be distributed. It is better to focus on free cash flow after maintenance, interest etc.

Sensex ups & downs

	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	Apr10	Apr 17		
Adani Ports & SEZ	1475.1	1573.1	▲	6.6
Eternal	240.3	252.6	▲	5.1
Tata Motors PV	342.6	360.2	▲	5.1
Power Grid	302.6	318.1	▲	5.1
Tech Mahindra	1440.4	1511.9	▲	5.0
Trent	3918.7	4106.0	▲	4.8
Bharat Electronics	442.3	462.7	▲	4.6
Asian Paints	2359.4	2463.4	▲	4.4
HUL	2155.6	2241.1	▲	4.0
NTPC	380.3	393.7	▲	3.5
L&T	3959.9	4095.0	▲	3.4
Tata Steel	206.6	212.1	▲	2.6
UltraTech Cement	11589.9	11887.3	▲	2.6
Kotak Mahindra Bank	374.8	383.5	▲	2.3
TCS	2524.4	2581.7	▲	2.3
Infosys	1292.4	1318.6	▲	2.0
ICICI Bank	1322.0	1347.5	▲	1.9
Bajaj Finserv	1808.6	1838.6	▲	1.7
SBI	1066.7	1080.4	▲	1.3
Sun Pharma	1654.7	1675.2	▲	1.2
Reliance Industries	1350.2	1365.1	▲	1.1
ITC	304.2	306.8	▲	0.9
Axis Bank	1351.5	1359.2	▲	0.6
Titan	4502.2	4526.3	▲	0.5
HCL Tech	1450.9	1442.5	▼	-0.6
Bharti Airtel	1870.0	1846.6	▼	-1.3
HDFC Bank	810.4	799.9	▼	-1.3
Bajaj Finance	924.4	908.7	▼	-1.7
Maruti Suzuki	13711.0	13452.3	▼	-1.9
M & M	3261.8	3199.4	▼	-1.9

How sectoral indices moved

	Apr 10	Apr 17	Movement	% change
POWER	7,287	7,780	▲	6.8
CAPITAL GOODS	72,181	76,112	▲	5.4
METALS	40,765	42,416	▲	4.1
CONSUMER DURABLES	58,203	60,330	▲	3.7
REALTY	5,890	6,095	▲	3.5
PSU	21,286	22,028	▲	3.5
FMCG	17,831	18,384	▲	3.1
IT	29,902	30,697	▲	2.7
HEALTHCARE	42,619	43,487	▲	2.0
OIL&GAS	26,681	27,145	▲	1.7
BANKEX	62,985	63,718	▲	1.2
TECK	15,606	15,768	▲	1.0
AUTO	58,714	58,444	▼	-0.5

How other indices moved

NIFTY NEXT 50	67,641	70,274	▲	3.9
NIFTY 500	22,347	22,869	▲	2.3
NIFTY 200	13,581	13,863	▲	2.1
NIFTY 100	24,810	25,239	▲	1.7
BANK NIFTY	55,913	56,566	▲	1.2

WHO AM I?.

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 My group will celebrate its centenary in the next few years. It began as a trading enterprise and entered manufacturing only in the 1960s, later winning several global quality awards.
- 2 I have undergone complex mergers and demergers, along with international acquisitions and business exits.
- 3 Total institutional ownership, combining domestic and foreign investors, remains in single-digits despite a long manufacturing track record and strong corporate governance standards.
- 4 My current chairman is reversing some of the restructuring undertaken by his father decades ago to restore synergies and scale benefits.
- 5 My industry is facing technological disruption, and the new chairman’s initiatives are expected to drive the next phase of growth.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL
Last week’s stock: Atul
Last week’s winner: Ibrahim Shiyas V

Heart at the right place

HEALTHCARE. Defensive sector, strong growth outlook and reasonable valuations support the stock of Narayana Health

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

The Indian hospital sector has long and secular drivers of growth drawing from both pricing and volume. In the current volatile macro-environment, reasonably-valued stocks in the defensive hospital sector with a growth outlook should be part of investor portfolio. Within the sector, Narayana Health (Naryana Hrudayalaya) offers growth at a reasonable valuation compared to peers. The base operations of Narayana in the short term, and capacity expansion in the longer term can support strong topline growth. Its margin profile should improve from scaling of ancillary operations in India and Cayman Islands pertaining to insurance and care centres. Recently, we had recommended investors accumulate the stock. Given the way markets have played out over the last month and the uncertainties ahead, its relative position in the markets has only got better. Hence, we reiterate our accumulate rating on the stock, which is now trading at one-year forward PE of 33 times. Investors with a three-to-five-year perspective can also gradually add to positions on any corrections.

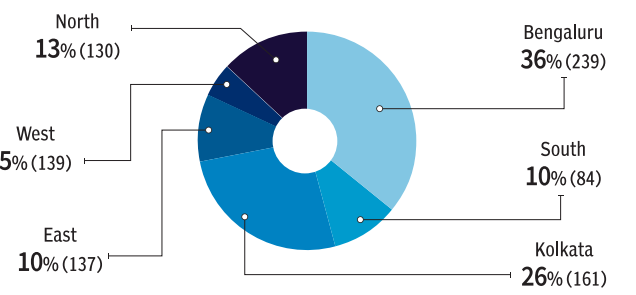
INDIA ORGANIC GROWTH

Narayana Health has a geographically well-diversified business with 54 per cent of consolidated revenue of ₹2,151 crore in Q3FY26 derived from India and 23 per cent each from Cayman and the UK.

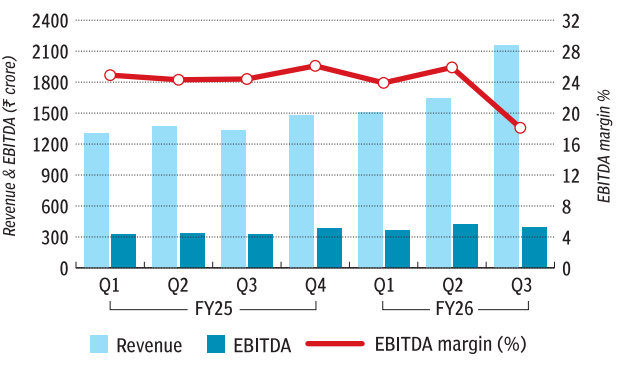
India revenue grew 9 per cent year on year in 9MFY26, excluding integrated care operations. This largely organic growth (without bed additions) is driven by pricing and volume growth. The company is significantly expanding complex procedures’ proportion in the revenue mix that includes robotic, cardiology, transplants and oncology operations. The other price levers include payor mix (self-paid, government schemes and insurance) and efficiency programmes. The ARPP (average revenue per pa-



Scope for improvement in ARPP Ex.Bengaluru



Strong margins impacted by acquisition



tient) has grown 11 per cent in Q3FY26 along with ALOS (average length of stay) reducing from 4.5 to 4.4 days. The latter metric, which measures the turnaround time for a patient and hence efficiency, has a higher scope to improve, as the company’s peers operate in the 3-3.5 days range.

As the table shows, the company is present in Bengaluru, Kolkata, Ahmedabad, Jaipur, Raipur, Gurugram and Delhi. The ARPP measure in different regions with the exception of Bengaluru has significant scope to

expand. The reason for the difference can be attributed to legacy of operations (age), competition, efficiency measures and proportion of complex procedures. The management noted that the work on improvement is ongoing and the difference between regions should reduce if not closing the gap with Bengaluru owing to its legacy of the operations.

Indian operations reported a 300-bps year-on-year improvement in EBITDA margins in Q3FY26 to 22.7 per cent. The company has a strong margin pro-

🎯 **ACCUMULATE**

Narayana Health
₹1,825.55

WHY

- Relatively insulated from economic uncertainty
- Reasonable valuation
- Good long-term growth prospects

file, which is comparable to peers despite a lower ARPP profile. This is owing to a strong suite of process efficiency measures, ERP design — built and deployed in-house. This is despite lagging operations in other clusters and added losses from integrated operations (explained below), which would otherwise have improved margins by another 100-200 bps.

Narayana’s India-integrated operations refer to NHIC (20 clinics and dialysis centres) and NHIL (health insurance programme ‘Aditi’). The nascent operations are scaling up with 98 per cent year-on-year revenue growth in 9MFY26. These operations are loss-making at the EBITDA level and are yet to reach a break-even point. This is possible on achieving scale of operations. The drag on India profitability should improve as the revenue growth adds to scale of operations.

GLOBAL OPERATIONS

Narayana’s international operations are from Cayman and the recently-acquired Practice Plus Hospitals. With 14 years of operations in Cayman Islands, the company has expanded its base here with a new facility. The segment operations grew 61 per cent in 9MFY26, driven by the new facility. Apart from inorganic addition, the company should target a higher market share as well. It also operates an insurance segment in this region, revenues of which are scaling up (from \$0.9 million in Q3FY25 to \$12.9 million in Q3FY26) and EBITDA losses at \$1.5 million in the quarter from the insurance segment.

The company reported its first

consolidated revenues from Practice Plus group in the third quarter. The UK chain of 12 hospitals was acquired in October 2025 at £189 million (₹2,200 crore). In Q3FY26, the segment reported revenues of £42 million and 10 per cent EBITDA margins compared to £250 million and 11.2 per cent EBITDA margin in FY25 prior to acquisition. Note that the consolidation is from November 6, 2025, only in the quarter.

Synergy levers for the acquisition include process developed in India and Cayman applied in the region. Also, the group has been reliant on NHS (the UK government care-provider), which has lower realisations and lower margins. The company anticipates shifting gradually to at least peer range of private payers mix in the medium term, which can improve financial performance from the acquisition.

CAPITAL EXPANSION

Narayana has growth levers in India, Cayman and the UK that should sustain low double-digit growth in the medium term. But the company has also launched a capex drive for longer-term growth. At a capex outlay of ₹3,000 crore, it is adding close to 2,000 beds in Bengaluru, Kolkata and Raipur to the current capacity of 5,750 beds. Most of the projects are expected to be completed by FY28 and will follow a gestation period of three-four years for optimal utilisation closer to Bengaluru metrics.

The company reported 32 per cent revenue growth in 9MFY26 with the consolidation of the UK hospital in Q3FY26. With a lower EBITDA margin than the group, its EBITDA margin has declined to 22 per cent in 9MFY26 compared to 25 per cent in FY25. Its margin levers should bridge the gap to an extent.

The company reported a net debt to equity of 0.53 times in December 2025. The management is focused in improving operation in the UK and Cayman Islands, and repaying the debt, which should further improve the ratio.

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (24,343) and Nifty Bank (56,566) extended the rally last week too and posted a gain of 1.2 per cent each. The chart of these indices and the futures and options (F&O) data show positive indications.

Like the preceding week, the FIIs (Foreign Institutional Investors) reduced the net short on index futures as well as on index call options, showing softening bearishness.

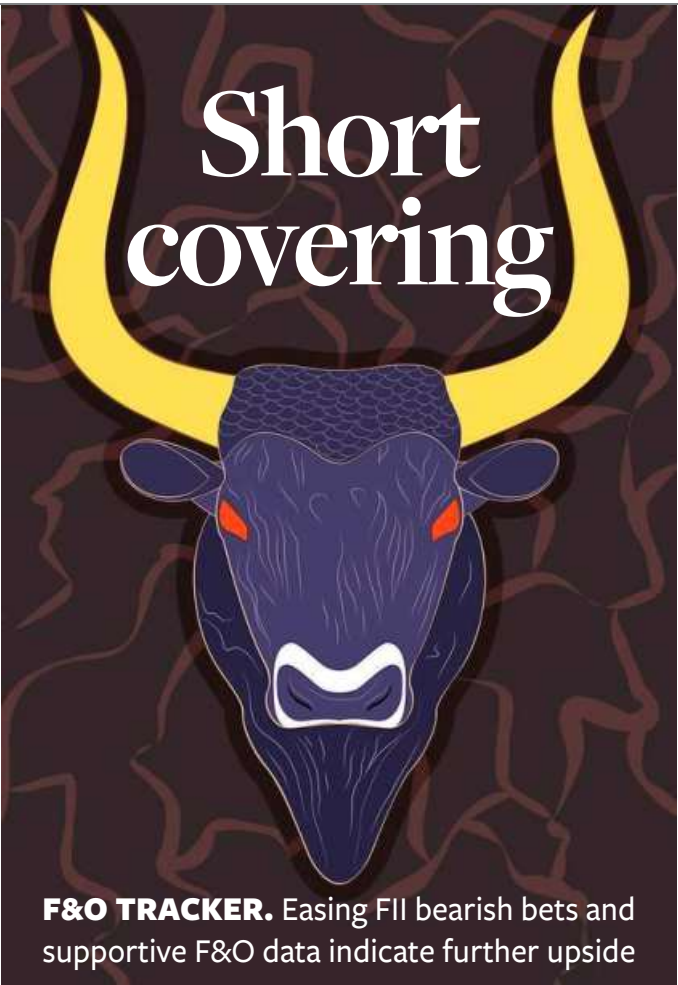
NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (April) (24,368) opened with a gap-down last Monday and slipped to mark a low of 23,625. However, the contract saw an intraday recovery and in the following sessions, it breached resistance at 24,000.

The chart shows that Nifty futures is sustaining above 24,000, and so, further rally is highly likely. We expect it to touch 25,000 soon. A breakout of this can trigger a rise to 25,700.

In case the base at 24,000 is breached, the contract can find support at 23,600 and 23,450. A breakdown below the latter can turn the outlook bearish. Support below 23,450 is at 23,000.

The positioning of F&O traders denote bullish expectations. We have been witnessing short covering in Nifty futures since the beginning of April. While the April futures is up over 8 per cent so far this month, the outstanding Open Interest (OI) of this contract has dropped from nearly 210 lakh contracts on March 30 to 172 lakh contracts on April 17.

Supporting the bullish bias, the Put Call Ratio (PCR) of April monthly options stood at nearly 1.2 on Friday compared to 1 a



week ago. An increase in the ratio is because of selling of relatively greater number of puts compared to calls over the last week. Traders sell puts when they hold a positive outlook or have no expectations of a fall.

The above factors show that the probability of a rally is high.

Strategy: Last week, we recommended buying Nifty futures (April) either on a decline to 23,600 or on a breakout of 24,200, whichever happens first. The contract, while made a low of 23,625 early last week, broke out of 24,200 on Wednesday.

- BROAD TREND**
- Index futures extend gains for second week
 - Sustain above key support levels
 - Hold on to existing long positions

Traders who initiated longs following the breakout can hold with a stop-loss at 23,800. When Nifty futures touches 24,700, revise the stop-loss to 24,400. Exit at 25,000.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (April) (56,667) began last week with a gap-down and made a low of 54,606.60 on Monday before seeing a recovery. On Wednesday, it surpassed a hurdle at 56,300 and since then it has been trading above it, showing a positive bias.

A weekly close above 56,300 adds strength to the bulls and we expect them to build on this base and eventually lift Nifty Bank futures to 59,000 in the near term. A breakout of this can take the contract higher to 60,000.

However, if there is a decline which can drag the price below 56,300, Nifty Bank futures can find support at 56,000 and 55,000. That said, for the outlook to turn weak, the contract should slip below 54,000, its 21-day moving average.

Nevertheless, there has been short covering since the beginning of April. The April futures has appreciated nearly 12 per cent so far this month whereas the outstanding OI has declined from 26.1 lakh contracts on March 30 to 19.8 lakh contracts on April 17.

Substantiating the positive inclination, the PCR of April options increased from 0.8 to nearly 1 over the last week, showing relatively greater selling of put options, a bullish sign.

So, broadly, we retain our bullish view based on the afore-said developments.

Strategy: We had suggested buying Nifty Bank futures (April) if it breaks out of 56,300 or sees a corrective decline to 54,125. The former occurred first.

Participants who bought Nifty Bank futures following the breakout can retain the trade. Maintain stop-loss at 55,000. When the contract touches 58,000, move the stop-loss to 56,900. Liquidate longs at 59,000.

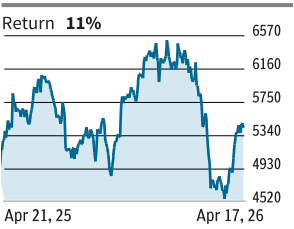
F & O QUERY



AKHIL NALLAMUTHU bl. research bureau

I'm planning to buy Persistent Systems futures for April expiry. Do you recommend buying now?

Saravanan Na



Persistent Systems (₹5,446.50): A month ago, the stock rebounded on the back of the support at ₹4,500. The price has risen above both 21- and 50-day moving averages and the scrip is now comfortably trading above ₹5,250, a potential

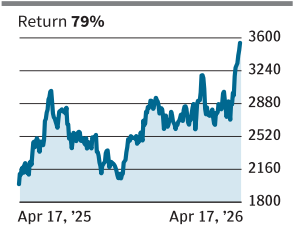
support. So, there is a bullish bias.

That said, there is also a key barrier ahead at ₹5,620, where the 200-day moving average coincides. While this is not a sign that the trend can turn bearish, given that the stock has seen a sharp rise recently, there is a very good chance for it to consolidate between ₹5,250 and ₹5,620 in the near term before establishing its next move.

The April futures of Persistent Systems too have the same key price points of ₹5,250 and ₹5,620 as support and resistance respectively. So, we suggest waiting for the futures to break out of the resistance at ₹5,620 before buying. Once there is a breakout, you may go long with stop-loss at ₹5,400 for a target of ₹6,000. After initiating the trade, when the contract rises to ₹5,850, revise the stop-loss to ₹5,700.

I have a short position on BSE April futures. Shall I exit now or hold?

Palani Shanmugam



BSE (₹3,531.50): The stock has surged over 30 per cent so far this month. The chart shows that the momentum is strong and also, there are no signs of a reversal. While there is a possibility for a corrective decline to ₹3,300, given the strength of the

uptrend, it might not happen. Or, the correction might come after the stock rises further. As the stock is now trading at record highs, there are no historical resistance levels that we can refer to. Given that the overall trend is up and as there is visibly no sign of a trend reversal, we suggest liquidating the short position. In fact, if there is a correction in price, you can consider going long on the stock of BSE. It is always advisable to have an exit plan in the form of stop-loss so that losses beyond a point can be arrested.

Send your queries to derivatives@thehindu.co.in.

Permitted lot size & option trade

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Shares to be exchanged between long and short option holders

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

From July, permitted lot size for the futures and options contracts on several stocks will be revised. Permitted lot size of contracts on seven stocks have been reduced and that on 43 stocks have been increased. This week, we discuss what you should be mindful of in relation to the permitted lot size.

CONTRACT MULTIPLIER
Permitted lot size indicates the number of shares that must be exchanged between the long and the short option holders at expiry if the option expires in-the-money (ITM). Suppose you are long a call option on REC and the strike expires ITM. Then, you are required to take delivery of 1400 shares of REC, the permitted lot size for the contract. Call (put) options that expire ITM require the long to take (give) delivery. But option traders typically do not prefer to take or give delivery of the underlying. They close their position before contract expiry. So, the permitted lot size acts more like a contract multiplier. If the call option on REC moves up by, say, two points,



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QUICK TIP
Permitted lot size may be useful if you are trading options intraday

your call position will gain 2800 (2 times 1400). The contract multiplier also works the other way; you will lose 2800 if the call option on REC loses two points.

Some traders are biased towards low-priced stocks in the spot market. If the same behaviour is exhibited in options,

then the bias would be to trade contracts that have large, permitted lot size. If you have a similar bias, you must be mindful of the related risks. Options typically lose more than they gain for a given change in the underlying price, the slower the price change. This is because when the underlying declines, the call option's delta and the theta work against the position, causing losses. In contrast, call option's delta work in its favour with the theta acting against the position when an underlying moves up.

The larger the permitted lot size, losses are magnified. It is best to initiate positions based on your view of the underlying, rather than shortlist the underlying based on permitted lot size. Permitted lot size may be useful if you are trading options intraday. The contract multiplier provides a leverage effect on the position. This is because theta is priced into an option as the loss in time value per day, not intraday.

OPTIONAL READING
The permitted lot size for a contract is revised upwards (downwards) when the underlying decreases (increases) significantly over a given period. Stocks with low price range will have large, permitted lot size. REC currently trades at 350 levels and has a permitted lot size of 1400. HDFC Bank has a permitted lot size of 550, as it currently trades at 800 levels. It is best to look at potential gains (permitted lot size times potential price change or potential percentage price change) to decide whether to initiate a position.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Hurdle ahead

BULLION CUES. Retain short with tight stop-loss

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Precious metals rallied last week too. Gold (\$4,832/ounce) was up 1.7 per cent whereas silver (\$80.8/ounce) surged 6.4 per cent, outperforming the yellow metal. In the domestic market, gold futures (₹1,54,609/10 gm) rose 1.3 per cent and silver futures (₹2,57,142/kg) was up 5.7 per cent.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,54,609)
Gold futures (June) ended last week with a gain. However, the price action fails to give any notable bullish signal. The resistance at ₹1,55,000 ought to be breached and the contract should cross above ₹1,57,000 to build a sustainable rally.

Suppose gold futures breaks out of ₹1,57,000, it can rally to ₹1,63,000 and ₹1,68,000. But in case there is a decline from the current level, gold futures can find support at ₹1,50,000. Subsequent support is at ₹1,47,500.

Trade strategy: Last week, we suggested initiating a short position at ₹1,54,000. Hold this trade. Retain the target and stop-loss at ₹1,44,000 and ₹1,58,000 respectively.



MCX-SILVER (₹2,57,142)
Silver futures (May) rallied last week. It marked a high of ₹2,61,750 on Friday before ending the week at ₹2,57,142.

While the contract has closed above a key level at ₹2,54,000, there is another resistance in sight at ₹2,63,000. To build a durable rally, silver futures should surpass the barrier at ₹2,63,000. Once this occurs, the contract can see a quick upswing to ₹2,80,000.

On the other hand, if silver futures declines from the current level, it can find support at ₹2,54,000 and ₹2,43,800.

Overall, as it stands, the chart shows a bullish bias but there is a resistance ahead which can arrest the rally.

Trade strategy: Traders with higher risk appetite can short silver futures at ₹2,58,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹2,44,000 and ₹2,63,000 respectively.

Rebound likely

CRUDE CHECK. However, it can be temporary

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices fell sharply last week, particularly on Friday on the news that the Strait of Hormuz will be opened. However, uncertainties still prevail.

Nevertheless, Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$90.40/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹7,666/barrel) were down 5.1 per cent and 9.8 per cent respectively. Here is our analysis:

BRENT FUTURES (\$90.40)
Brent crude oil futures, which was largely oscillating in the range of \$94-100 in the recent sessions, breached the support at \$94 on Friday. It marked a low of \$86.09 before ending the session at \$90.40.

Despite the sell-off, the contract managed to stay above the 50-day moving average, now at \$89.20. So, from the current level, there might be a minor rally, possibly to the \$96-100 range.

In case the downtrend resumes, Brent futures can drop to \$85 or even to \$80.

But if \$100 is breached, the



price can rise to \$105 or \$110.

MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹7,666)
Crude oil futures (May) was range-bound between ₹8,250 and ₹8,750. But on Friday, the contract broke below the ₹8,250-₹8,000 support band.

From the current level, there is a support ahead at ₹7,500, where the 50-day moving average coincides. On the back of this, there could be a rally to ₹8,250-₹8,750 range.

If the contract starts falling again, crude oil futures can drop to ₹6,500 or to ₹6,000. But in case the price surpasses the hurdle at ₹8,750, the upswing can extend to ₹9,500 or ₹10,000.

Trade strategy: Traders can buy crude oil futures now at ₹7,666. Target and stop-loss can be ₹9,500 and ₹7,150 respectively. But, note that volatility can remain high, and so, risk-averse traders can stay out.

Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Apr 17	Weekly change %	As on Apr 17	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	68019	-16	214400	-2
Future Index Short	258972	-10	82681	9
Net Futures	-190953	-7	131719	-8
Index Call options Long	491399	-5	2848387	15
Index Call options Short	632096	-9	2829292	20
Net Call options	-140697	-21	19095	-85
Index Put options Long	857527	-2	2661560	11
Index Put options Short	535582	-1	3105594	8
Net Put Options	321945	-3	-444034	-3

FII has cut net short on both index futures and index call options. Net long on puts have also seen a marginal reduction. Overall, there is a bullish tilt.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Apr 17)				
GODFRYPHLP	2,207.70	5.0	26.1	212.9
ANGELONE	322.47	14.8	1040.1	109.5
MOTILALOFS	815.45	4.7	56.8	81.6
ADANIPOWER	198.50	12.9	1348.1	67.4
FORCEMOT	22,378.00	-1.1	2.4	61.7
FALL (as on Apr 17)				
LODHA	872.55	5.6	305.7	-9.4
BOSCHLTD	37,505.00	0.5	7.5	-5.6
SAMMAANCAP	154.53	-0.8	1347.8	-4.5
MFSL	1,683.20	1.7	111.8	-4.2
VOLTAS	1,440.10	9.5	206.7	-3.9

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Apr 20)

SAIL	SAMMAANCAP
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Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI (Weekly change %)	Indication
COMMODITIES (as on Apr 17)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Apr	363.5 (1.6)	2,483 (-22)	Short covering
COPPER	30-Apr	1,272.9 (5.2)	8,538 (-7)	Short covering
CRUDEOIL	18-May	7,666.0 (-9.8)	10,578 (66)	Short build-up
CRUDEOILM	18-May	7,662.0 (-9.9)	27,066 (128)	Short build-up
GOLD	5-Jun	1,54,609.0 (1.3)	8,191 (8)	Long build-up
GOLDGUINEA	30-Apr	1,23,333.0 (1.2)	12,383 (-13)	Short covering
GOLDM	5-May	1,53,176.0 (1.3)	36,856 (9)	Long build-up
GOLDPETAL	30-Apr	15,446.0 (1.1)	1,52,753 (-15)	Short covering
GOLDTEN	30-Apr	1,53,398.0 (1.2)	27,736 (-10)	Short covering
LEAD	30-Apr	195.1 (0.8)	496 (-2)	Short covering
NATURALGAS	27-Apr	250.2 (0.6)	31,162 (-25)	Short covering
SILVER	5-May	2,57,142.0 (5.7)	5,733 (0)	Short covering
SILVERM	30-Apr	2,58,533.0 (5.5)	13,217 (-9)	Short covering
SILVERMIC	30-Apr	2,58,539.0 (5.5)	47,403 (-12)	Short covering
ZINC	30-Apr	339.1 (2.4)	2,112 (6)	Long build-up
CURRENCIES (as on Apr 17)				
USDINR	28-Apr	92.98 (-0.2)	17,02,223 (-12)	Long unwinding
EURINR	28-Apr	109.76 (0.5)	27,384 (0)	Long build-up
GBPINR	28-Apr	125.82 (0.5)	24,285 (2)	Long build-up
JPYINR	28-Apr	58.56 (-1.5)	126 (168)	Short build-up

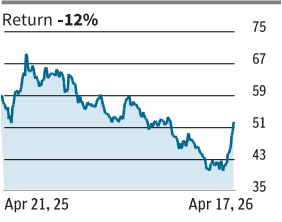
F&O Strategy

Buy Suzlon Energy futures

KS Badri Narayanan

The outlook for Suzlon Energy (₹52.93) turned strongly positive after the recent recovery.

Immediate resistance for the stock is at ₹60, a close above which can trigger fresh rally to ₹72. Key support levels are at ₹47.75 and ₹38.20. We expect the upward momentum to continue for some more time.



F&O pointers: Suzlon Energy April futures and May futures closed at ₹52.96 and ₹53.34 respectively against the spot price of ₹52.93. The counter has been facing unwinding of open interests due to profit taking. However, May contracts are witnessing a steady long build-up.

Strategy: Consider going long on Suzlon Energy futures while keeping the initial stop-loss at ₹50. If the stock opens on a positive note, shift the stop-loss ₹53. Traders can aim for an initial target of ₹56-57. The stop-loss should be used judiciously to manage risk.

Traders should bear in mind that Suzlon Energy is one of the volatile stocks, demanding prudent trade management. So this strategy is strictly for traders with higher risk tolerance. While risk-averse traders can stay away from this, participants with a penchant for risk can even aim for a higher target of ₹60.

Follow-up: Our recommendation on L&T would not have provided any opportunity.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

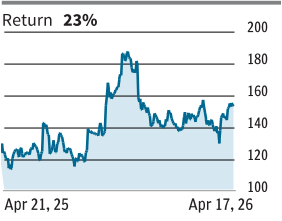
Short Take

Sammaan Capital to exit F&O

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Sammaan Capital is set to be excluded from the derivatives segment after failing to meet the eligibility norms laid down by the exchanges.

As per the latest circular, no fresh contracts will be introduced beyond the current expiry cycle, and the stock will cease to be available in the F&O segment from July 1, 2026. Existing contracts for April, May and June will continue to trade till expiry.



The exit follows SEBI's framework, which mandates that only stocks with adequate liquidity and market depth may remain in the derivatives space. To qualify, stocks must rank among the top 500 by average market capitalisation and traded value, and meet thresholds such as median quarter sigma order size (₹75 lakh), market-wide position limit (₹1,500 crore) and average daily delivery value (₹35 crore) over a rolling six-month period.

In addition, the Product Success Framework (PSF) requires minimum activity levels — at least 15 per cent of active traders or 200 participants (whichever is lower), trading on 75 per cent of sessions, average daily turnover of ₹75 crore and open interest of ₹500 crore. Failure to meet any of these for three consecutive months triggers exclusion. The stock appears to have fallen short on one or more of these parameters, leading to its removal.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and the Nifty Bank index extended the rise for the second consecutive week. All the three indices were up about 1.2 per cent each. Indeed, the mid and small cap segments outperformed the benchmark indices. The Nifty Smallcap 250 and the Nifty Midcap 150 indices surged 4.36 per cent and 3.5 per cent respectively.

The week began on a negative note with a wide gap-down. However, the indices managed to bounce back immediately and sustained higher all through the week. This clearly signals that buyers are entering the markets at lower levels. That in turn keeps our overall bullish view intact. The Indian benchmark indices are likely to go higher in the coming weeks. Any intermediate dips are likely to be short-lived.

FPIs BUY

The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) snapped their six-week selling spree. The FPIs were net buyers of Indian equities last week. There was a net inflow of about \$514 million into the equity segment. It is important now to see if the FPIs continue their purchase or not. We have to wait and watch.

NIFTY 50 (24,353.55)

Short-term view: Nifty can rise to test the 24,500-24,650 resistance cluster this week. Failure to breach 24,650 on its first attempt can trigger a corrective fall to 24,100-24,000 or 23,800. However, a fall below 23,800 is unlikely. An upward reversal anywhere from the 24,100-23,800 region will have the potential to breach 24,650. Such a break can take the Nifty up to 24,900-25,000 initially and then 25,500 eventually.

A break below 23,800 is needed to increase the downward pressure and drag the index down to 23,400-23,300.

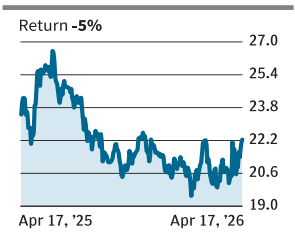
Medium-term view: The strong bounce after a gap-down open last week strengthens our broader bullish view. Nifty can rise to 26,500 in the medium term. Failure to breach 26,500 and a subsequent fall below 25,000 will continue to keep it in the broad 22,000-26,500 range.

The bias continues to remain positive. So, we expect a decisive break above 26,500 eventually. Such a break will boost the momentum. It can then take the Nifty higher to 28,000 and 30,000 in the long term.

MOVERS & SHAKERS

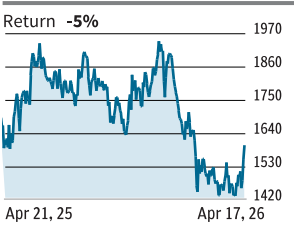
AKHIL NALLAMUTHU bl. research bureau

IRB Infrastructure Developers (₹22.26)
Set to breakout



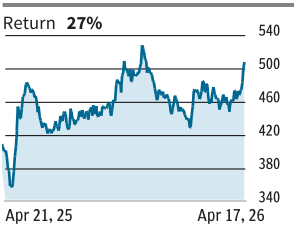
₹23 soon. Once this occurs, we are likely to see a swift rally with first stop at ₹26. Post consolidation around this level, the scrip can then see another leg of uptrend to ₹30. So, buy at ₹22 and add more longs at ₹20.50. Place initial stop-loss at ₹18. On a rally to ₹26 and ₹28, revise the stop-loss to ₹23 and ₹25 respectively. Exit at ₹30.

PB Fintech (₹1,600.65)
Reverses trend



is a chance for the stock to retest ₹1,550, eventually, we expect it to appreciate to ₹1,900. Traders can buy now at ₹1,600 and accumulate at ₹1,550. Keep stop-loss at ₹1,450. When the price touches ₹1,750, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,680. On a rally to ₹1,850, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,800. Book profits at ₹1,900.

Star Health and Allied Insurance Co (₹503.30)
Cracks key barrier



dominate in the coming weeks. We expect the price to hit ₹650 soon. So, participants can go long at ₹503 and buy more shares if the price dips to ₹480. Place stop-loss at ₹400. When the stock touches ₹550, alter the stop-loss to ₹515. Tighten the stop-loss to ₹570 when the price hits ₹600. Liquidate the longs at ₹650.



INDEX OUTLOOK. Any intermediate dips will be short-lived

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Nifty 50 gets a follow-through rise



NIFTY BANK (56,565.70)

Short-term view: An immediate resistance is at 56,900. Above that, 58,000 is the next resistance. We can expect the Nifty Bank index to test 58,000 initially. Thereafter, a corrective fall to 56,000 is a possibility.

Eventually, the index can break 58,000 and rise to 60,000-60,500 in the coming weeks.

In case, the index fails to bounce back from around 56,000, then an extended fall to 54,000-53,500 can be seen. Thereafter a fresh leg of upmove can happen. In that case, the rise to 60,000-60,500 will get delayed.

Medium-term view: As mentioned last week, a strong weekly close above 60,500 will strengthen the momentum. That will clear the way for a rise

to 64,000-65,000 in the medium term.

From a long-term perspective, the Nifty Bank index has the potential to target 68,000-69,000 on the upside. There is no major threat for this bullish view as long as the index sustains above 53,500. This view will go wrong only if the index declines below 50,000.

SENSEX (78,493.54)

Short-term view: Strong supports are at 77,450 and 76,900. These supports can be tested initially if the Sensex fails to rise past 79,200. However, the bias will remain positive and a fall below 76,900 is less likely.

Sensex can rise to 80,000 first. A break above 80,000 can then clear the way for a rise to 82,000.

NEAR-TERM RESISTANCES

- Nifty 50: 24,500, 24,650
- Sensex: 79,200, 80,000
- Nifty Bank: 56,900, 58,000

Medium-term view: The overall picture remains positive. The level of 83,000 is an important intermediate resistance. A break above it can boost the momentum. It can then take the Sensex up to 86,000 or even 90,000 in the medium term. Such a rise will also open the doors for the Sensex to target 98,000 in the long term.

In case the Sensex turns down from around 86,000, the broader sideways range can continue to remain intact.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (22,045.20)

A strong rise and a decisive close above 21,650 last week strengthens the bullish case. The level of 21,650 will now act as a good resistance-turned-support. A rise to 22,700-23,000 is possible in the coming weeks. The price action thereafter will be crucial.

Failure to breach 23,000 can drag the index down to 22,000-21,000 and even lower again.

The bias is positive to see a bullish breakout above 23,000 if not immediately, but eventually. Such a break can take the Nifty Midcap 150 index up to 26,000-

26,500 initially and then to 28,000-28,500 eventually in the long term.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (16,439.25)

Immediate resistances are at 16,580 and 16,650. Failure to breach 16,650 can trigger a corrective fall to 15,800 or 15,500. Fresh buyers are, however, likely to come into the market and limit the downside.

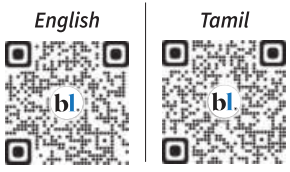
As such, a fresh rise from 15,800 or 15,500 can trigger a breakout above 16,650. Such a break can take the index higher to 17,500 initially, and then to 18,300 eventually.

From a long-term perspective, the index has to breach 18,300 decisively to gain momentum. Such a break will see the Nifty Smallcap 250 index rallying to 22,500-23,000 and even 24,000 in the long term.

As long as the index stays above 14,000, the long-term bullish view will remain valid.

bl.portfolio
video

Watch bl. Guru share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week



Bourses break a barrier

US MARKET OUTLOOK. Surge last week strengthens momentum for rise



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

FRESH BUYING

The price action last week signals the dollar index is not getting strong sellers below 98

ated only if the index declines below 48,000.

S&P 500 (7,126.06)

The index has surged well above the psychological mark of 7,000. However, a crucial resistance is around 7,200. Failure to break this resistance and a subsequent fall below 7,100 can drag the index down to 6,950 in the coming weeks.

A strong and sustained rise above 7,200 is needed to strengthen the momentum. If that happens, then the S&P 500 will have the potential to target 7,600 in the coming months.

The price action around 7,200 will need a close watch this week.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (24,468.48)

The index has risen well above the crucial resistance level of 24,000. It is important for the NASDAQ Composite to sustain above the 24,000-23,950 support zone. If it does, then there is a potential to see 26,500-27,500 on the upside in the coming months.

This bullish view will get negated if the index declines below

23,950. In that case, a fall-back to 23,000-22,800 can be seen again.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The break below 98.60 and the fall to 97.50 almost happened last week. The dollar index (98.23) touched a low of 97.63 and then has bounced from there. The daily chart signals the absence of fresh sellers below 98. That leaves the near-term bias positive. Resistance is in the 98.60-98.70 region. A break above it can give some relief and reduce the downside pressure. That in turn can take the dollar index up to 99.30-99.50.

The dollar index will come under more selling pressure only if it declines below 97.50. If that happens, 96.70-96.50 can be seen on the downside.

TREASURY YIELD

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.25 per cent) seems to be struggling to get a sustained break above 4.3 per cent. That leaves the yield vulnerable to break 4.2 per cent and fall to 4.15 per cent or even 4.1 per cent in the next few weeks.

After this fall, there is a good chance the 10Yr Yield may rise back towards 4.25 per cent again. It is important to see if this bounce is sustainable or not.

Ideally, the yield has to rise past 4.3 per cent to bring back our bullish view of seeing 4.5-4.6 per cent on the upside.

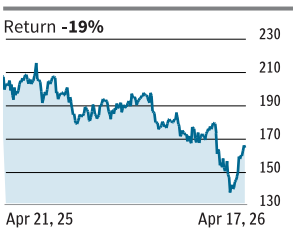
TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K
bl. research bureau

I have bought GAIL (India) shares at ₹200. What is the outlook? Can I continue to hold?

Reshma, Chennai

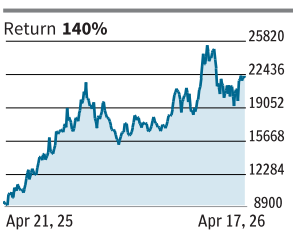


GAIL (₹157.80): The stock is in a strong downtrend since October 2024. This fall confirms that the earlier uptrend that was in place since March 2020 has been reversed. The outlook is bearish. Strong resistances are at ₹163

and ₹182. The stock has to rise past ₹182 to turn the outlook bullish. But that looks unlikely. There is a danger of the price declining towards ₹125-122 in the coming months. Any bounce from this ₹125-122 support zone can be capped at ₹150 or ₹160. In a worst-case scenario, the stock price can tumble to ₹95 and even lower in the long term. A break below ₹122 can trigger this fall. It is better to exit the stock now and accept the loss.

I have bought shares of Force Motors at ₹18,500. Should I book profit now or hold it for the long term?

Ramesh M Tavhare, Mumbai

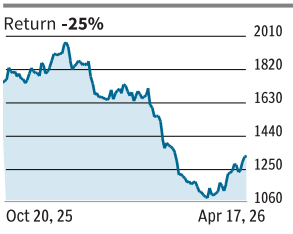


Force Motors (₹22,382.80): The trend is up. But you may have to be a little careful as the stock is now consolidating. Supports are ₹19,650 and ₹17,100. The uptrend will come under threat only if the price declines below

₹17,100. The upside is open to see ₹33,500-34,500. From a long-term perspective, there is the potential to see ₹84,000 in the next one-two years. For now, keep a stop-loss at ₹19,450 for 20 per cent of your holding. For the balance, keep the stop-loss at ₹16,300. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹26,450 for the entire holdings when the price touches ₹29,900. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹29,200 and ₹31,700 when the price touches ₹30,800 and ₹33,100. Exit the stock at ₹34,500.

I intend to buy Coforge for the long term. What could be a good entry point for this stock?

Ashish V

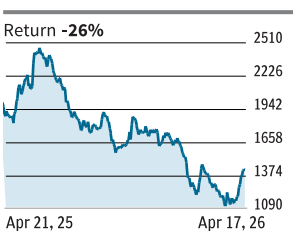


Coforge (₹1,316.70): The short-term picture is unclear. A rise to ₹1,500-1,550 is possible. But, thereafter, the price can reverse lower again. A subsequent fall below ₹1,200 will increase the danger of the price

tumbling to ₹750. Ideally, the stock must rise above ₹2,000 to become convincingly bullish. You have to wait either for a rise above ₹2,000 or a fall to ₹750. Alternatively, if you can take high risk, then buy 20 per cent of the intended amount now. The balance you can buy either after a breakout above ₹2,000 or on a fall to ₹780, whichever happens first. Keep the stop-loss at ₹620. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹1,970, ₹2,250 and ₹2,650 when the price touches ₹2,120, ₹2,450 and ₹2,900 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹3,000.

I have bought Aditya Birla Real Estate shares at ₹680 in 2022. Should I hold it or exit?

Harpriya Sood



Aditya Birla Real Estate (₹1,422): The stock peaked at ₹3,141 in October 2024 and has been in a downtrend since then. Ideally you should have come out of this stock much earlier. However, you can exit the stock now. As long as the stock

trades below ₹1,800, there is a danger of seeing a fall to ₹600. Keep the following in mind: always enter a trade with a specific target and stop-loss. Most importantly, you have to adhere to those levels. When the price goes up in your favour move the stop-loss higher. This will help you to exit a trade earlier if any sudden reversal happens. Even if the stock goes up beyond your target, do not worry; there is always another trade.

● Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all!" So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

Last week's prize winner
Vasant Kelkar

Last week's winning stock
HFCL

Closing price (Apr 10)
₹84.40

Closing price (Apr 17)
₹95.45

Return:
13.09 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50, rose 1.2 per cent and 1.3 per cent, respectively, last week. BSE Power and BSE Capital Goods led the gains, delivering 6.8 per cent and 5.4 per cent, respectively, while BSE Auto and BSE Teck lagged, delivering -0.5 per cent and 1 per cent, respectively

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Reality	Teck
P/E	21.4	21.6	33.9	15.2	57.2	63.9	34.4	38.7	23.0	22.3	9.1	36.6	12.2	38.4	26.3
P/BV	3.3	4.2	6.4	2.3	15.0	16.5	7.7	6.6	6.4	2.6	1.4	4.9	2.4	4.9	7.9
Dividend Yield	1.3	1.2	1.2	1.1	0.4	0.5	1.5	0.5	2.6	1.4	2.8	1.1	2.2	0.4	2.1
Weekly Return (%)	1.3 ▲	1.2 ▲	-0.5 ▼	1.2 ▲	5.4 ▲	3.7 ▲	3.1 ▲	2.0 ▲	2.7 ▲	4.1 ▲	1.7 ▲	6.8 ▲	3.5 ▲	3.5 ▲	1.0 ▲
Monthly Return (%)	3.3 ▲	3.2 ▲	5.0 ▲	3.3 ▲	12.0 ▲	8.7 ▲	4.2 ▲	2.4 ▲	10.3 ▲	10.3 ▲	3.3 ▲	12.0 ▲	5.5 ▲	10.1 ▲	6.5 ▲
Annual Return (%)	2.1 ▲	-0.1 ▼	22.0 ▲	2.3 ▲	24.5 ▲	5.6 ▲	-10.6 ▼	4.3 ▲	-6.8 ▼	47.9 ▲	6.0 ▲	15.8 ▲	18.2 ▲	-7.0 ▼	-5.4 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
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360 One [1]	1112.1	29.0	38.4	16.5	202512	51.5	18.4	22.1	10.0	9.6	14.3	2.0	1273.0	861.8	
3M India [1]	33394.2	542.7	57.8	16.5	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	-0.4	39.8	0.0	38200.0	28300.0	
A B B [2]	7030.0	78.8	89.2	19.0	202512	5.1	-18.3	27.4	39.4	2.4	9.8	0.1	7085.9	4640.5	
Adani Real Estate [1]	4148.9	1.0	202512	-59.8	-389.2	-0.3	-317.3	4.3	0.0	0.0	2535.0	1080.1			
Adarsh Hsg. Fin. [1]	496.8	23.9	20.8	3.1	202512	18.2	22.7	18.7	20.0	4.0	11.4	2.8	547.8	424.2	
Aarti Industries [5]	440.7	10.2	43.1	2.8	202512	25.8	221.7	13.3	1.6	4.2	6.2	0.7	494.0	338.2	
AAVAS Financiers	1347.8	61.9	21.8	2.8	202403	21.4	12.3	25.4	14.2	8.3	9.9	3.2	2238.4	1050.3	
ABT India [1]	25797.2	717.3	36.0	13.7	202512	6.8	4.2	9.3	14.2	0.1	45.0	0.0	35992.1	62531.8	
ACC [1]	1431.9	134.0	10.7	1.4	202512	8.6	-65.4	16.4	1.6	0.5	17.9	0.0	2123.3	1250.0	
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	305.0	8.3	36.8	3.9	202512	42.3	-3.7	61.7	319.0	13.5	7.4	2.8	324.3	195.7	
Action Const. Eq. [2]	916.4	35.5	25.8	6.1	202512	-2.3	4.2	0.3	8.6	0.8	40.2	0.0	1390.0	74.1	
Adani Energy Sol [1]	1229.8	18.7	67.4	6.5	202512	15.4	-17	20.0	4.8	8.7	10.1	2.2	1266.6	745.5	
Adani Entep. [1]	2128.4	25.5	87.0	5.3	202512	8.6	1823.5	-5.1	-15.4	6.2	9.0	1.8	2612.8	1753.5	
Adani Green [1]	1126.8	10.4	108.8	9.5	202512	7.6	-106.8	14.8	10.1	3.8	9.4	6.4	1179.2	767.0	
Adani Ports [2]	1573.1	54.8	28.7	4.3	202512	21.9	24.9	26.3	18.9	6.6	14.0	0.0	1584.0	1181.0	
ARPI Power [2]	198.4	5.9	33.4	6.6	202512	-8.9	-18.9	-1.9	-12.2	12.9	21.2	0.7	199.9	101.1	
Adani Total Gas [1]	632.9	5.8	108.4	15.4	202512	16.4	11.4	17.7	-3.9	7.0	17.4	0.4	797.4	453.5	
Aditya AAM [1]	1071.8	35.3	30.4	8.7	202512	7.4	21.0	12.0	11.8	7.5	35.5	0.0	1040.0	595.5	
Aditya Bkr. Fas.	64.2	-6.2	1.3	202512	7.9	-215.9	9.7	45.5	6.4	0.0	13.0	0.7	71.7	53.6	
Aditya Birla Cap. [1]	208.2	13.5	25.1	2.8	202512	27.4	40.5	13.0	-3.2	-0.5	9.5	4.4	369.3	186.0	
Aegis Logistics [1]	740.9	21.9	32.3	4.2	202512	1.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	12.0	14.5	0.9	946.5	576.0	
Aether industries [1]	1180.2	16.9	70.0	6.7	202512	44.4	46.2	52.7	93.2	-0.9	0.7	1250.0	723.2		
Afcoss Infrastr.	334.2	13.9	24.0	2.3	202512	-7.3	5.7	-3.1	-1.9	2.8	14.4	0.6	479.1	265.9	
Affle 3R [2]	1468.1	31.1	47.1	6.4	202512	19.2	19.1	19.2	39.7	4.7	16.6	0.1	2186.8	1251.9	
AI Engineering [2]	3958.2	124.8	31.7	5.0	202512	-0.1	14.6	-2.6	10.3	4.8	32.1	0.1	4200.0	3000.0	
Ajanta Pharma [2]	2790.4	81.2	34.4	8.1	202512	20.0	17.6	14.8	13.0	-0.5	12.0	0.0	3158.2	2335.0	
Alencab Pharma [2]	789.8	33.8	23.3	2.9	202512	10.8	21.0	13.2	11.6	8.4	13.1	0.2	1107.8	635.3	
Alkem Labs [2]	4583.7	20.8	27.8	5.0	202512	10.7	11.2	11.0	2.4	11.0	2.2	0.0	4583.7	208.8	
Alkyl Amines [2]	1434.8	35.3	40.6	5.1	202512	-4.6	-3.4	-1.5	1.1	0.7	18.2	0.0	2448.4	1212.4	
Allied Blenders [2]	573.5	9.6	59.8	10.3	202512	3.0	19.5	14.0	135.6	12.2	21.0	0.9	720.0	302.5	
Alok Industries [1]	14.3	-1.6	-0.3	202603	3.1	-214.3	0.2	14.9	2.9	0.0	0.0	23.5	1.1		
Amara Raja Ener.	778.5	7.4	20.8	1.8	202512	4.2	-22.2	5.1	-26.8	4.9	15.6	0.0	1095.9	571.5	
Amara Wnterp. [2]	7960.3	66.0	12.5	7.7	202512	37.2	38.9	27.8	6.9	2.3	0.0	18.0	50.0	540.0	49.0
Amulja Cements [2]	459.0	15.6	29.5	2.0	202512	9.2	-49.9	16.4	-8.7	3.1	12.7	0.0	62.5	394.0	
Anand Rathi Wea.	3689.6	47.7	77.4	30.7	202603	29.7	40.5	22.3	32.1	2.9	56.8	0.1	3733.9	1636.8	
Anand Raj [2]	513.2	14.6	35.1	3.4	202512	20.0	30.8	22.6	36.8	5.1	10.9	0.1	744.1	403.0	
Angel One [1]	322.3	19.5	16.4	2.5	202512	1.4	32.3	19.5	10.2	22.2	4.8	202603	38.3	-1.7	
Apurinds [1]	11474.2	246.9	46.5	9.5	202512	16.3	29.8	20.8	22.8	1.1	32.6	0.1	11775.7	4819.2	
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	2105.5	41.1	51.2	12.7	202512	7.2	42.9	9.2	80.0	2.0	22.0	0.2	2300.9	1493.0	
Apollo Hospitals [5]	7699.1	126.3	60.9	12.2	202512	17.2	38.8	14.5	38.6	2.5	17.5	0.6	8099.0	6680.0	
Arcadis Unile [1]	455.3	17.9	25.8	1.8	202512	1.4	34.5	14.5	19.5	4.2	20.7	0.1	483.3	218.4	
Aptus Vaea Hou. [2]	126.5	17.8	13.9	2.7	202512	23.0	24.0	28.1	25.5	10.4	15.1	1.5	364.9	160.0	
Asahi India Glas [1]	851.6	12.3	69.2	5.9	202512	8.4	32.8	5.3	-4.7	-2.0	13.1	0.9	1073.0	657.7	
Ashok Leyland [1]	174.8	6.2	28.3	8.2	202512	23.6	36.2	13.4	30.1	-1.8	14.9	0.3	215.4	10.5	
Ashtor Paints [1]	240.4	56.4	12.1	1.5	202512	3.9	5.7	1.3	-6.4	-4.4	24.4	0.1	288.5	216.0	
Aster DM Health.	688.3	7.0	98.1	8.5	202512	12.9	-10.1	8.5	38.5	1.0	11.6	0.5	732.0	492.7	
Astral [1]	1612.9	19.2	84.1	11.5	202512	10.3	5.2	6.7	-2.1	-1.1	20.8	0.1	1768.0	1240.0	
Astrazeneca Phar [2]	8508.8	83.2	102.3	26.6	202512	38.9	-42.3	34.5	24.1	2.6	32.9	0.0	101653.1	7630.0	
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	2597.2	10.8	26.7	1.5	202512	14.6	16.5	14.5	19.5	4.0	20.0	0.1	2633.0	4718.8	
Atul [1]	6592.2	108.8	32.7	3.3	202512	11.1	47.8	13.3	42.9	2.1	12.8	0.0	7793.9	5563.0	
AU Small Finance [1]	990.8	30.9	32.1	4.1	202512	14.9	26.3	22.3	13.6	0.9	0.0	10388.8	576.5		
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1385.7	60.8	22.8	2.3	202512	9.0	12.9	8.3	0.7	-0.6	14.2	0.2	1394.1	1017.0	
Autum Invest [1]	459.6	2.8	10.7	2.4	202512	-22.5	-70.2	-16.0	-9.5	4.2	29.7	0.1	683.5	355.2	
Avenue Super. [1]	4629.3	43.9	105.4	13.2	202512	13.3	18.3	15.4	5.3	5.2	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.7	
AWL Agri Busine. [1]	185.1	7.4	25.1	2.4	202512	10.5	-30.0	21.8	-19.5	1.5	19.8	0.3	291.3	171.2	
Axis Bank [2]	1359.2	84.5	16.1	2.1	202512	4.8	4.0	4.5	-6.8	0.6	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1041.3	

B H&L [2]	316.7	2.3	135.4	4.5	202512	16.4	189.8	10.4	56.9	11.3	3.2	0.4	317.7	205.2
B PCL [2]	312.1	57.6	5.4	1.4	202512	5.2	90.0	0.5	78.3	4.2	15.7	0.7	391.9	266.6
Bajaj Auto [1]	977.2	313.9	30.6	8.0	202512	21.2	27.8	14.8	18.7	-0.4	28.1	0.2	1018.6	755.1
Bajaj Finance [1]	188.2	28.4	6.7	1.5	202512	18.4	20.2	18.4	15.4	1.7	11.4	3.8	110.2	58.4
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1838.6	62.1	29.6	3.9	202512	24.9	11.6	15.6	15.9	1.7	12.4	4.9	2194.7	1598.2
Bajaj Holdings [1]	10366.6	660.2	15.7	1.7	202512	127.6	15.3	-24.1	-2.2	3.7	11.5	0.7	1437.2	8597.5
Bajaj Housing [1]	91.8	0.0	30.8	3.6	202512	15.2	23.2	18.9	27.1	6.9	9.5	4.7	137.0	72.6
Balrisha Indus [1]	247.2	67.6	3.6	1.1	202512	1.0	11.5	6.1	1.7	0.0	19.3	0.0	202.3	20.9
Balrampur Chini [1]	486.0	22.2	21.9	2.5	202512	22.0	61.0	15.4	9.0	2.7	11.1	0.6	127.0	393.4
Banpan Bank [1]	174.4	6.3	27.9	1.1	202512	-0.9	-51.8	0.0	-59.4	3.8	0.0	0.0	69.25	13.4
Bank of Baroda [2]	280.0	37.6	7.4	0.9	202512	3.2	6.4	4.7	-4.7	-1.4	0.0	0.0	325.6	212.1
Bank of India [1]	148.1	22.4	6.6	0.9	202512	4.0	6.7	7.9	19.7	0.1	0.0	0.0	178.5	104.1
Bank of Maha [2]	72.7	8.4	8.6	1.8	202512	16.1	27.4	19.3	22.9	3.1	0.0	0.0	77.0	47.1
BASF India [1]	703.1	84.3	44.0	4.2	202512	6.3	0.9	-1.9	-39.7	2.5	17.9	0.1	5418.2	2906.6
Bata India [5]	1757.1	14.9	50.7	6.4	202512	2.8	9.0	-0.6	23.4	5.8	14.6	0.9	130.1	60.5
Batafrop Corp.Sol [1]	490.5	14.9	32.9	7.1	202512	4.6	19.8	7.7	28.7	2.2	23.8	0.0	654.0	427.6
BEML Ltd [5]	1771.1	29.9	59.2	5.3	202512	23.7	-191.7	8.4	-4.8	9.3	11.7	0.1	2437.4	1361.1
Berger Paints [1]	468.8	9.6	48.8	8.7	202512	0.3	5.1	3.1	-1.7	3.1	24.8	0.1	601.6	364.5
Bharat Dynamics [1]	1380.8	15.8	87.3	202512	-31.4	-50.4	57.2	2.5	2.7	10.2	0.0	2096.0		
Bharat Electron [1]	462.7	8.2	56.7	15.7	202512	24.0	20.5	14.5	19.5	4.6	36.9	0.4	473.3	291.2
Bharat Forge [2]	186.6	20.4	76.1	9.5	202512	25.0	41.5	5.2	18.2	3.5	11.9	13.6	196.4	104.0
Bharat Airtel [5]	1846.0	50.4	36.7	9.5	202512	19.6	-12.1	25.0	68.0	-1.3	14.3	2.2	2174.7	1747.2
Bhilai Steel [1]	435.8	1.0	43.8	1.8	202512	1.8	21.3	17.8	0.7	0.0	18.8	0.0	435.8	1.0
Bhilai Foods [1]	660.2	10.0	66.3	11.1	202512	11.2	117.6	13.9	-8.3	3.1	18.2	0.2	820.9	591.2
Biccom [1]	358.2	5.1	70.9	1.5	202512	9.3	173.36	14.4	3.9	2.8	6.9	0.8	425.0	308.8
Birla Corp [1]	975.0	74.2	13.1	1.2	202512	43.1	141.6	6.4	151.7	3.2	7.2	0.6	1537.2	773.9
Birla Finance [2]	295.0	17.5	22.4	1.0	202512	1.2	22.7	1.2	15.1	6.6	1.0	0.0	295.0	17.5
BIS International [1]	275.0	14.2	19.0	5.7	202512	43.6	34.8	47.6	41.9	2.9	39.0	0.1	421.9	218.5
Blue Dart Express [5]	5407.2	122.5	44.1	7.9	202512	6.9	30.1	7.1	25.1	4.5	17.1	0.7	7212.2	4695.0
Blue Jet Health [2]	422.9	16.6	25.0	5.8	202512	-39.6	-59.4	20.6	25.1	3.8	40.4	0.0	1028.2	325.2
Bluebird [1]	1865.2	26.0	21.1	1.0	202512	1.0	2.0	-2.0	1.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	1865.2	26.0
Bosch [5]	396.5	78.3	47.8	7.9	202512	9.4	7.9	11.3	14.2	0.5	20.5	0.0	418.94	327.05
Bransford Solutions [2]	252.4	3.0	2.8	2.8	202512	11.6	-77.20	12.4	3.4	-3.6	0.0	0.0	43.87	20.7
Breco [1]	150.0	1.0	24.5	0.0	202512	0.0	15.1	1.0	15.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	151.0	61.0
Britannia Indus [1]	5733.0	100.3	87.2	12.0	202512	9.5	16.9	8.0	11.0	3.1	51.9	0.4	6337.0	5280.0

Financial security in the age of job volatility

LAYOFF IMPACT. Personal accounts expose the reality of fragile finances and reveal how income disruptions are forcing a rethink of financial preparedness

Anjana C Shriram

Sudden layoffs and job uncertainty are exposing how even well-paid professionals across sectors were less financially resilient than their salaries suggested. The shock is cutting across age-groups and income levels, showing that high salaries and marquee roles did not necessarily come with enough financial cushion. From mid-career executives juggling EMIs and dependents to younger employees freezing investments and older professionals confronting redundancy, the fallout is proving both financial and emotional. Their stories show how quickly a steady income can mask vulnerability, especially when households carry fixed obligations but lack a deep emergency buffer.

Jagadeesh Srinivas | *Finance professional*
This 39-year-old finance professional began his career in 2008 after completing an MBA from Anna University. Over nearly two decades, he has built experience across investment banking, treasury and capital markets, working with multiple banks, MNCs and IT firms.

In 2024, he joined a global firm operating as a start-up in India as a Lead Business Analyst, earning about ₹30 lakh annually. On the personal front, Chennai-based Srinivas has been the primary breadwinner since his father's death over a decade ago. His responsibilities include supporting his mother and managing family milestones, including his sister's recent marriage, which coincided with a layoff. He currently manages monthly EMIs exceeding ₹1 lakh, spanning a home, car and personal loan. An active investor, he participates in equities (non-intraday), mutual funds via SIPs and cryptocurrencies, with monthly SIPs of ₹6,000-7,000. Despite tight cash flows, he managed to build a corpus of ₹15-20 lakh over the years — which came in handy during his sister's wedding in November. His investing journey has seen both gains and losses, shaping a practical understanding of market cycles. "Uncertainty is inevitable," he says, adding that the layoff, though difficult, has strengthened his resilience and long-term perspective. He says he did not follow a formal financial plan earlier and is sceptical of rigid planning even after the layoff. "You cannot live life in a 100 per cent planned manner," he says. With his current funds, he estimates he can stay comfortable for only about two months.

Ritu Jayapurkar | *Software engineer*
Ritu Jayapurkar, a software engineer with about three years of experience, began her career at a global technology company in the telecom domain at Pune. Based away from her family, she has had minimal financial liabilities so far.

Earning around ₹10 lakh annually, she had been investing 40-50 per cent of her income across instruments, adjusting allocations based on market conditions. However, a recent layoff has shifted her priorities. Her immediate focus is finding a new job, with investment decisions now on hold. While she has received a performance bonus recently and expects a severance package, she is yet to plan its deployment. Upskilling is on the radar, though her current focus remains on securing employment.

She believes her savings and expected severance should allow her to remain in Pune while she continues her job search. "It's only a matter of time before I land one," she signs off.

Vishal Mathur | *Fintech professional*
Vishal Mathur, 43, began his career in 2007 with a private bank in Mumbai before moving to a global bank in Pune and later relocating to Singapore, where he spent over a decade. He returned to Pune in 2022 and continued with the same organisation through a transition following its acquisition. In late 2025, he was informed that his role would be made redundant, despite having recently delivered a key project. Though placed on garden leave with continued salary, the uncertainty was mentally taxing. By February 2026, Mathur secured an internal role within the organisation, in Pune itself, avoiding job-loss and maintaining financial stability.

As the sole earning member of a family of five, his responsibilities are significant. He has no loans but spends ₹50,000-75,000 monthly on therapy for his child with ADHD, alongside education for two other kids and household expenses. Though his salary is around ₹3 lakh a month, he says it is largely absorbed by his family's current obligations. According to him, his current savings are essentially what he could amass



GETTY IMAGES

QUICK FIXES

- Build six-month emergency funds before scaling EMIs, lifestyle, or investments
- Mandate affordable health cover continuity and temporary job-loss insurance options
- Prioritise severance, reskilling support, and faster re-employment assistance after layoffs

while in Singapore (10-and-a-half years), which have been deployed across equities, mutual funds and real estate.

Dheeraj Pandya | *Software professional*
San Francisco-based Dheeraj Pandya began his career in 2000 and moved to the US in 2009, joining a global technology firm in 2013. His wife, a dentist, has been practising since 2015. Their son is set to begin college this year, with tuition fee expected to exceed \$50,000 annually. The family's monthly outgo is about \$16,000, including EMIs on two homes, two cars and utilities. "Until seven months ago, we shared these expenses. Now, my wife is handling them entirely," he says.

In January 2025, they bought a new home and spent \$100,000 on upgrades, moving in by March. By September, he was laid off. "We've managed for seven months, but it's getting difficult," he says, pointing to rising fuel costs: "Gas was \$3.20 a gallon in February; it's now \$6.20."

The income shock was compounded by a steep fall in the value of his stock options, from \$350 to \$130 per share. Monthly passive-fund investments of \$6,000-7,000 have now been paused.

Healthcare has emerged as a major expense. While employed, insurance cost \$4,000 a month, of which he paid \$700. Now, dental and vision coverage alone costs about \$80-100 per month for the entire family.

To ease cash flow, the family reduced the EMI on their first home from \$7,000 back to \$4,000. Discretionary spending has been cut sharply. Regular travel — once every two-three

months at roughly \$3,000 per trip — has stopped. "We've eliminated waste," he says. "We now buy groceries only when needed."

Bhargav Ramesh | *Software professional*
A 38-year-old software testing professional, Bhargav has around 13 years of experience, all in Chennai. He worked at his last organisation from November 2023 to December 2025.

He comes from a modest background — his father was a machine operator and his mother a homemaker. Married in 2023, his wife is employed as a PEGA System Architect.

At the time of his layoff, his CTC was ₹19 lakh per annum. His only liability — a personal loan with a ₹15,000 EMI — was closed two months ago. They have no other loans and own a 10-year-old car outright.

Bhargav invested ₹15,000 monthly in PPF, while his wife invested through mutual fund SIPs. He also contributes ₹50,000 each month to his parents, who live in their own home, and hopes to continue contributing going forward too. Their expenses are modest, with surplus savings channelled into chits and gold purchases. He also pays health insurance premia of about ₹1 lakh per parent annually.

The couple's monthly household expenses, including rent, are around ₹35,000.

Despite intending to, they were unable to build an emergency fund. Over the past 18 months, they have spent ₹9 lakh on IVF treatment. "While I was working, we shared the cost. After the layoff, it's been managed through my wife's salary and my severance," he says. However, he can't hold on for long comfortably, he says. The family can manage for about seven months with current funds, after which supporting the household would become difficult if he remains unemployed, he adds.

For now, PPF contributions are on hold. Once re-employed, he plans to resume ₹15,000 monthly investments. The couple is also considering buying gold each month (₹20,000-25,000) and starting SIPs of about ₹15,000.

Meanwhile, Bhargav has spent ₹35,000 on upskilling, completing two certifications to improve job prospects, and has enrolled in French classes to learn a new language.

Names changed on request

How to stay afloat when your paycheque suddenly stops

bl.interview

Gayathri G

As layoffs become more frequent across sectors, financial preparedness is moving from a "good-to-have" to a necessity. Planners say the difference between stress and stability often comes down to liquidity, insurance cover, and disciplined investing. Venkateswaran Muthukrishnan, Partner, Marina Wealth, also an AMFI registered MF distributor, outlines practical steps — from building an emergency corpus to managing EMIs and investments — to help households navigate sudden income disruptions.

What is the ideal emergency corpus individuals should maintain today?

There is no one-size-fits-all number. The ideal corpus depends on factors such as risk appetite, age, job stability, and financial commitments. As a baseline, individuals should maintain at least six months of expenses, including EMIs, though a more conservative range could go up to 2-3 years.

In your experience, how many clients actually have this buffer in place?

More than 85 per cent of our clients have built such buffers, largely due to sustained financial planning and awareness. Younger or first-time investors are typically still in the process of creating this emergency corpus.

What are the first financial steps one should take within the first week of losing a job?

Start with a detailed review of expenses — identify essential and non-essential outflows and eliminate avoidable spends, especially auto-debits. Check whether employer-provided health insurance continues during the notice or garden leave period, and secure independent coverage, if needed. Submit any pending reimbursements and clear high-interest liabilities such as credit card dues.

Which expenses should be prioritised, and what should be cut first?

Households should first map all expenses and prioritise essentials such as housing, food, education, and healthcare. Discretionary spends — like multiple OTT subscriptions, unused memberships, or low-utility services — should be the first to go.

How should individuals approach ongoing EMIs after a sudden income disruption?

If supported by an emergency corpus, most EMIs can continue. Otherwise, liabilities should be categorised. "Good" EMIs, such as home or vehicle loans, should be maintained, while "bad" debt — like credit card dues or personal loans — should be prioritised for repayment.

Would you recommend restructuring loans, using savings, or liquidating investments? In what order?

Investments should typically be evaluated first, followed by savings. We will have to critically evaluate the current investments and bucket them into core and non-core investments. Over a period of time, people accumulate investments(!) in life insurance policies, real estate, etc. It would be good opportunity to re-evaluate the need for each of them and after discussing with your financial consultant or advisor, exit or utilise them to pay off or restructure the loans.

What happens to health insurance after job-loss?

In most cases, employer-provided health insurance ceases once employment ends. But in few cases, the group insurance cover can be converted into a stand-alone health insurance policy by retaining the vintage of the group cover, particularly with PSU insurance companies. However, coverage for older dependents may face stricter scrutiny during such transitions.

How critical is it to maintain personal health and term insurance during this phase?

Adequate life and health insurance provides financial protection at a time when income visibility is uncertain.

Should individuals pause SIPs or redeem investments during a layoff?

This is case-specific, but the general thumb rule is to stop the SIPs to conserve cash. Redemption decisions should depend on liquidity needs, the nature of investments, and available buffers.



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Individuals should maintain at least six months of expenses, including EMIs, though a more conservative range could extend up to 2-3 years

VENKATESWARAN MUTHUKRISHNAN
Partner, Marina Wealth

What is the recommended order of liquidation across asset classes?

Typically, liquid instruments such as fixed deposits and mutual funds are redeemed first. Low-yield insurance products can also be exited to reduce both liabilities and future premium obligations. Real estate should be critically evaluated, especially if it was acquired without clear financial utility.

Is it advisable to dip into long-term retirement savings such as EPF or NPS?

This should generally be avoided, as it disrupts long-term compounding. However, in extreme situations, it may be necessary. The trade-off is a potential compromise on retirement goals for short-term liquidity.

What are the most common financial mistakes people make after losing a job?

Becoming overly risk-averse and shifting entirely to low-return assets, chasing high-yield but risky investments, lending money to friends/family despite uncertain liquidity, and making discretionary big-ticket purchases. Another frequent error is prepaying long-term loans prematurely, which reduces liquidity. Many also avoid discussing their situation with advisors or family, which can worsen decision-making.

How should preparedness differ across household types — single earners vs dual-income households, or individuals with dependents?

Dual-income households typically have greater flexibility, as the likelihood of both earners losing jobs simultaneously is low. Single-income families, especially those with dependents, should maintain a larger emergency corpus.

Are you seeing an increase in clients seeking advice on layoff preparedness? Has resilience improved?

Yes, many of our clients want to know their preparedness, if they have to face such a situation. We discuss their needs covering various components such as living expenses, children's education or marriage and other commitments, if any, and indicate an amount which they would need for financial security. When they see that their portfolio has adequate buffer for meeting these type of situations, they heave a sigh of relief and thank us for considering it.

How can someone be 'layoff-ready' in the next six months if they wanted to?

Start by creating a budget that clearly separates essential and discretionary expenses to determine your minimum monthly outgo. Build an emergency fund covering 6-12 months of expenses, including EMIs, parked in FDs or liquid funds. Ensure adequate life cover — at least 10x your annual income — through a term policy, with full disclosure of any pre-existing conditions. Complement this with a standalone health cover of at least ₹10 lakh, and, if risk-averse, add a super top-up of around ₹50 lakh for extra protection.

Prioritise repaying high-interest debt, especially credit card dues. Avoid large discretionary commitments. Keep a line of credit available but only as a last resort. Review your portfolio by separating core and non-core assets, and identify those that can be easily liquidated. Finally, understand your severance and other entitlements in case of a layoff, and use this knowledge to negotiate a better payout where possible.

Health insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male, non-smoker, sum insured of ₹10 lakh living in a metro city

Insurer	Plan name	Key features	Premium (₹)
ICICI Lombard	Elevate	OPD rider with no sub-limits. Single pvt AC Room. ₹2 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,792
Care	Care Supreme	Guaranteed 7x increase over 5 years with rider. No Room Rent Limit. ₹15 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover.	10,838
Niva Bupa Health	Health ReAssure	Unlimited claims up to the cover amount. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	12,033
Star Health	Super Star	Fully loaded plan with one-time unlimited claim. Unlimited bonus. Lock the age till 50. No Room Rent Limit. ₹5 lakh NCB.	8,173
Aditya Birla Health	Activ One Max	100% issuance offer guarantee. No Room Rent Limit. ₹10 lakh Renewal Bonus; optional Unlimited Restoration of cover	8,828
Tata AIG	Medicare Select	Special discount for young families and salaried customers. Single pvt AC Room. ₹5 lakh NCB. Unlimited Restoration of cover.	7,474
Reliance General	My HealthCare	Additional 30% discount on premium & fully customisable plan. Single pvt AC Room. ₹3.33 lakh NCB. Restoration of cover once a year.	7,326

Term insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male/female, non smoker, living in a metro city, Sum assured ₹1 crore with coverage up to 70 yrs

Insurance company	Plan name	Max coverage up to	Max policy term	Annual premium		Claim settlement ratio (%)
		(years)		Male	Female	
Aditya Birla Capital	Super Term Plan	85	55	11,167	9,203	98.4
Bajaj Life	eTouch II	85	55	10,714	8,832	99.3
Canara HSBC Life	Young Term Plan - Life Secure	99	69	11,345	9,477	99.2
HDFC Life	Click 2 Protect Super	85	55	12,390	10,531	99.7
ICICI Prudential	iProtect Smart	99	69	14,462	9,645	99.3
Axis Max Life	Smart Term Plan Plus	85	55	11,217	9,527	99.7
SBI Life	Smart Shield Plus	79	49	13,206	11,109	99.4
TATA AIA Life	Sampoorna Raksha Promise	100	70	11,111	9,429	99.4
Bandhan Life	iTerm Prime	70	40	11,466	9,963	99.7

Claim settlement ratio as per data provided by insurer
Source: www.policybazaar.com, Date: April 17, 2026

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme		Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
		Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit		4.0	4.0	Annually
Post Office Time Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5 ^a	7.5 ^a	Annually
Sukanya Samridhi Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on March 30, 2026
#Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	61.1	15235	1.7	0.6	1.8	13.9	11.8	13.8	0.31
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	109.0	69948	1.4	0.9	4.5	16.8	15.4	14.5	0.47
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	89.8	46521	1.5	0.7	6.2	17.8	17.6	14.9	0.52
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1111.3	35458	1.6	1.0	1.5	14.0	14.4	13.4	0.41
*****	JM Large Cap	150.6	390	2.4	0.9	3.8	14.6	12.7	11.3	0.33
*****	Kotak Large Cap	563.8	9794	1.7	0.6	4.9	14.4	12.6	12.9	0.34
*****	SBI Large Cap	93.0	48926	1.5	0.8	6.3	13.6	12.5	12.5	0.34
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	514.5	26702	1.6	1.0	3.3	14.4	12.9	12.5	0.35
***	Bandhan Large Cap	76.5	1821	2.1	0.9	6.0	16.2	13.2	13.0	0.34
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	217.7	2344	2.0	0.8	4.3	15.2	13.2	12.8	0.36
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	82.5	1322	2.1	0.6	3.4	13.6	12.5	12.9	0.33
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	1007.5	6821	1.9	1.2	4.6	13.8	11.3	11.2	0.29
***	Invesco India Largecap	68.7	1537	2.0	0.7	6.1	17.2	14.5	13.0	0.37
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	110.3	35343	1.5	0.6	3.8	12.3	11.2	13.3	0.28
***	Tata Large Cap	501.3	2448	2.0	1.0	4.9	14.3	13.0	12.2	0.35
***	UTI Large Cap	264.3	11203	1.8	0.9	1.3	12.0	10.4	11.9	0.25
**	DSP Large Cap	458.8	6620	1.8	0.9	0.4	16.2	12.6	11.8	0.37
**	HSBC Large Cap	473.6	1667	2.2	1.3	5.4	14.5	12.0	12.7	0.29
**	LIC MF Large Cap	53.3	1253	2.2	1.1	-0.9	10.8	9.7	10.8	0.22
**	Union Largecap	23.0	403	2.6	1.8	3.2	12.3	11.2	-	0.27
**	Axis Large Cap	55.8	28661	1.6	0.7	0.4	11.5	8.7	12.1	0.18
*	Groww Largecap	42.8	117	2.5	1.3	7.1	13.8	11.7	11.4	0.28
*	PGIM India Large Cap	327.8	501	2.4	0.9	1.3	10.2	9.2	10.4	0.21
-	Mahi Manu Large Cap	22.3	653	2.4	0.8	0.3	13.2	11.5	-	0.30
-	Taurus Large Cap	157.0	46	2.6	2.3	5.1	15.1	12.4	10.7	0.31
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	136.8	14109	1.7	0.5	10.1	23.7	19.4	16.4	0.54
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	335.0	25295	1.6	0.9	6.7	19.3	18.3	15.0	0.50
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	1024.4	27005	1.6	0.8	8.4	21.2	20.1	16.2	0.63
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	32.7	13973	1.7	0.6	9.1	19.1	15.2	-	0.38
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	112.6	2782	2.0	0.8	1.8	16.8	16.4	15.5	0.40
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	636.8	34871	1.6	0.7	10.7	17.5	17.3	15.2	0.52
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	182.6	5234	1.8	0.9	9.4	21.7	18.3	14.6	0.54
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	90.2	422	2.3	1.1	10.9	17.4	15.3	13.1	0.41
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	245.7	22203	1.6	0.7	2.4	15.7	13.9	15.4	0.36
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	616.6	15780	1.7	0.7	5.2	19.7	16.0	15.3	0.45
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	88.0	4067	1.9	0.5	10.3	18.9	15.7	14.9	0.42
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	98.8	8436	1.8	0.6	10.3	24.2	18.2	16.1	0.43
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	346.6	27373	1.6	0.6	10.3	18.6	16.2	15.8	0.44
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	151.4	38138	1.5	0.6	10.3	17.0	14.2	17.3	0.36
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1466.2	6299	1.9	1.1	7.0	20.6	17.2	13.4	0.47
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	185.9	3135	2.1	1.4	6.7	16.2	13.9	11.8	0.36
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	37.6	2109	2.0	0.9	3.8	17.6	14.2	14.7	0.38
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	85.1	6031	1.8	0.7	6.8	16.6	14.5	14.6	0.36
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	481.9	7040	1.8	0.7	-3.6	11.0	11.0	12.6	0.29
**	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	911.8	5103	1.9	1.1	9.5	15.9	11.0	12.1	0.22
*	Navi Large & Midcap	35.1	267	2.3	0.5	6.1	12.9	12.9	13.2	0.31
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	27.5	4238	1.9	0.8	14.8	20.9	16.5	-	0.35
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1994.7	91335	1.4	0.7	5.7	20.7	20.4	16.7	0.65
*****	JM Flexicap	92.9	4504	1.9	0.7	-0.8	19.1	17.3	16.4	0.45
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	84.0	128966	1.3	0.6	6.3	18.1	16.4	17.4	0.59
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	38.2	2957	1.9	0.5	7.5	18.4	15.6	14.9	0.41
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1589.1	17536	1.7	0.9	2.3	17.5	15.9	13.7	0.43
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	35.3	5332	1.8	0.5	4.1	12.6	11.3	14.0	0.28
*****	Union Flexi Cap	50.0	2079	2.1	1.0	5.0	14.9	13.4	13.4	0.34
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1840.8	23018	1.7	0.9	10.1	18.6	14.4	14.4	0.38
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	206.4	6651	1.9	1.2	6.3	15.8	13.1	11.3	0.34
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	333.8	11922	1.7	0.6	6.0	14.7	12.9	14.3	0.34
***	DSP Flexi Cap	100.5	10726	1.7	0.7	3.2	16.3	13.0	14.4	0.32
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	218.7	4724	2.0	1.2	9.2	18.9	15.6	13.4	0.36
***	Kotak Flexicap	85.6	50146	1.5	0.6	9.1	16.5	13.8	14.2	0.35
***	SBI Flexicap	107.4	20626	1.7	0.9	4.4	12.4	11.5	12.4	0.29
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.7	3310	1.9	0.6	3.0	16.0	12.3	-	0.32
***	Axis Flexi Cap	26.1	11413	1.7	0.7	4.5	15.0	11.1	-	0.24
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	56.7	11679	1.7	0.8	0.6	21.6	12.6	12.8	0.28
**	Navi Flexi Cap	23.5	232	2.2	0.5	11.4	13.9	12.8	-	0.32
**	UTI Flexi Cap	298.0	20438	1.7	1.1	-2.8	10.0	7.0	11.8	0.11
*	LIC MF Flexi Cap	96.1	895	2.4	1.7	7.6	13.9	11.0	10.2	0.26
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.5	118	2.4	0.5	0.4	10.5	9.4	-	0.18
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	219.2	306	2.7	2.6	2.6	13.6	11.7	10.0	0.28
-	Quant Flexi Cap	100.8	5687	1.9	0.7	7.6	18.6	19.2	19.3	0.48
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	281.2	2861	2.0	0.9	4.8	18.1	16.7	14.5	0.41
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	816.5	14681	1.8	1.0	9.1	21.1	18.2	15.4	0.51
-	Invesco India Multicap	121.9	3550	1.9	0.7	0.2	16.4	14.7	13.6	0.34
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	36.2	5661	1.8	0.5	11.0	21.3	18.5	-	0.46
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	296.0	46321	1.5	0.7	8.4	21.3	21.7	15.8	0.61
-	Quant Multi Cap	612.5	6574	1.8	0.7	2.9	12.8	14.1	17.1	0.33
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	369.6	2525	2.0	0.9	5.1	16.6	15.7	14.9	0.41
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	102.9	13554	1.7	0.5	13.0	25.7	21.2	18.6	0.55
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	198.9	85358	1.4	0.8	14.2	24.7	22.1	18.2	0.64
*****	Quant Mid Cap	208.9	7002	1.8	0.9	0.3	16.9	18.8	16.6	0.48
*****	Invesco India Midcap	179.0	9895	1.7	0.6	15.8	26.7	21.5	18.4	0.51
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	34.4	4099	1.9	0.5	13.1	24.8	20.6	-	0.53
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	92.8	31047	1.6	0.9	2.1	22.5	23.9	16.8	0.55
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4333.6	39676	1.6	0.8	15.2	26.4	22.8	19.2	0.60
***	Axis Midcap	114.2	28835	1.6	0.5	12.0	20.1	16.0	15.8	0.41
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	106.0	2129	2.0	0.5	13.8	21.4	17.9	16.8	0.48
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	327.9	6569	1.9	1.1	27.3	26.7	21.1	17.5	0.56
***	Kotak Midcap	137.8	55676	1.4	0.4	16.4	22.1	19.1	18.0	0.50
***	PGIM India Midcap	62.6	9681	1.7	0.5	5.5	14.1	14.7	15.7	0.37
***	SBI Midcap	232.7	20576	1.7	0.9	4.2	16.3	16.7	14.3	0.45
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1419.1	11898	1.7	0.9	13.6	24.8	20.1	15.4	0.52
***	Tata Mid Cap	443.3	4993	1.9	0.7	13.2	21.9	17.8	16.4	0.48
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	790.3	5493	1.9	1.0	10.6	20.9	17.7	14.1	0.44
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2678.2	10899	1.8	1.0	5.6	21.3	16.7	14.9	0.41
**	Taurus Mid Cap	116.3	109	2.6	2.2	5.0	15.8	13.7	15.0	0.32
**	UTI Mid Cap	297.8	10482	1.8	0.9	10.3	17.7	15.2	14.4	0.37
**	DSP Midcap	148.8	17492	1.7	0.7	14.3	20.6	14.3	15.2	0.35
**	HSBC Midcap	415.7	11342	1.7	0.7	22.0	26.3	18.8	17.2	0.43
**	LIC MF Midcap	28.6	301	2.5	1.4	8.6	20.6	15.1	-	0.34
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	167.5	61809	1.4	0.7	8.8	21.3	22.9	20.8	0.54
*****	Quant Small Cap	248.7	25821	1.7	0.8	5.4	20.1	22.6	18.5	0.52
*****	AXIS Small Cap	103.9	23919	1.6	0.6	6.6	18.0	18.6	18.1	0.50

Rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
★★★★	Bank of India Small Cap	47.5	1770	2.0	0.5	10.1	21.8	20.6	-	0.44
★★★★	Invesco India Smallcap	41.7	9208	1.7	0.5	11.0	24.8	22.2	-	0.51
★★★★	DSP Small Cap	201.1	15300	1.7	0.8	16.7	21.4	20.2	16.7	0.48
★★★★	HDFC Small Cap	133.5	33724	1.6	0.8	8.8	17.9	19.8	17.6	0.49
★★★★	ICICI Pru Smallcap	84.6	7538	1.8	0.8	7.4	16.3	18.6	16.0	0.51
★★★★	Kotak Small Cap	247.3	15157	1.7	0.6	3.9	15.3	15.7	16.5	0.36
★★★★	Sundaram Small Cap	262.8	2983	2.0	0.9	13.1	20.6	19.4	14.7	0.45
★★★★	Tata Small Cap	34.8	9621	1.7	0.4	-5.1	13.7	18.0	-	0.42
★★★★	Union Small Cap	50.9	1666	2.2	1.1	17.8	20.3	18.9	15.9	0.42
★★	Franklin Ind Small Cap	166.4	11724	1.8	1.0	6.1	19.0	20.3	15.4	0.45
★★	HSBC Small Cap	78.0	13882	1.7	0.8	6.3	17.0	20.4	18.3	0.44
★★	SBI Small Cap	165.5	32286	1.6	0.8	3.0	14.3	15.7	17.6	0.40
★	Aditya Birla SL Small Cap	86.0	449	1.9	0.9	11.3	19.0	15.0	13.1	0.32
★	LIC MF Small Cap	30.3	552	2.4	1.1	6.5	19.2	19.3	-	0.42
-	Canara Robeco Small Cap	37.9	11603	1.7	0.6	7.2	16.2	19.4	-	0.48
-	Edelweiss Small Cap	43.1	5108	1.8	0.5	8.4	19.6	19.8	-	0.49
EQUITY - VALUE FUNDS										
★★★★★	HSBC Value	113.3	13371	1.7	0.7	12.2	22.8	19.8	16.6	0.54
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Value	146.8	55852	1.5	1.0	6.0	19.0	19.1	15.5	0.70
★★★★★	Bandhan Value	464.6	9042	1.8	0.7	3.4	15.9	17.1	15.8	0.49
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Value	224.5	7993	1.8	1.1	5.8	21.9	18.7	16.1	0.50
★★★★	HDFC Value	753.0	6588	1.9	1.0	9.5	19.6	17.0	14.3	0.45
★★★★	JM Value	91.7	721	2.4	1.3	0.3	18.9	17.2	16.2	0.41
★★★★	Templeton India Value	706.3	2005	2.1	1.0	4.2	16.2	17.9	14.6	0.52
★★★★	Union Value	28.3	337	2.5	1.2	8.9	18.3	16.0	-	0.45
★★★★	UTI Value	164.1	8663	1.9	1.2	4.7	17.7	14.9	14.0	0.42
★★	Aditya Birla SL Value	129.1	5639	1.9	1.0	11.9	20.6	16.5	12.8	0.39
★	Tata Value	350.3	7909	1.8	0.8	6.7	18.7	16.6	15.3	0.46
★	LIC MF Value	25.7	181	2.5	1.4	14.8	17.5	14.7	-	0.33
★	Quantum Value	119.4	1018	2.1	1.1	-0.1	15.6	12.7	11.7	0.38
-	Groww Value	26.6	60	2.5	1.1	6.0	16.4	13.7	10.6	0.36
-	Sundaram Value	215.5	1212	2.3	1.7	3.4	12.6	12.3	11.6	0.33
EQUITY - TAX SAVING (ELSS) FUNDS										
★★★★★	DSP ELSS Tax Saver	137.9	15044	1.7	0.7	3.3	19.1	16.0	15.7	0.45
★★★★★	Quant ELSS Tax Saver	377.8	10978	1.7	0.8	11.2	18.1	18.1	20.0	0.44
★★★★★	SBI ELSS Tax Saver	431.6	28441	1.6	1.0	5.2	22.0	18.8	14.9	0.56
★★★★	Bandhan ELSS Tax Saver	151.1	6274	1.8	0.7	5.2	14.8	14.9	15.2	0.41
★★★★	Bank of India ELSS Tax Saver	163.9	1260	2.0	0.8	9.3	17.8	15.6	16.5	0.37
★★★★	Canara Robeco ELSS Tax Saver	174.4	7810	1.7	0.6	6.5	14.9	13.3	14.8	0.36
★★★★	HDFC ELSS Tax Saver	1372.5	14615	1.7	1.1	2.5	19.3	18.8	14.4	0.60
★★★★	JM ELSS Tax Saver	47.0	196	2.4	1.0	4.3	18.3	15.4	15.7	0.38
★★★★	Mirae Asset ELSS Tax Saver	48.7	22940	1.6	0.6	8.1	16.6	14.0	17.2	0.37
★★	Baroda BNP Paribas ELSS Tax Saver	96.5	809	2.2	1.0	7.6	18.8	13.8	12.9	0.35
★★	Franklin Ind ELSS Tax Saver	1418.6	5684	1.9	1.1	1.2	17.2	15.6	12.9	0.45
★★	ICICI Pru Long Term Equity	925.0	12810	1.7	1.1	4.3	16.4	14.0	13.5	0.39
★★	Kotak ELSS Tax Saver	173.1	5587	1.8	0.6	4.4	14.5	13.9	14.4	0.36
★★	Mahli Manu ELSS Tax Saver	27.4	828	2.2	0.8	2.0	12.9	13.0	-	0.34
★★	Motilal Oswal ELSS Tax Saver	52.7	3969	1.8	0.7	15.0	24.8	19.3	17.1	0.41
★★	Quantum ELSS Tax Saver	118.6	193	2.1	0.9	0.0	15.4	12.7	11.7	0.38
★★	Sundaram ELSS Tax Saver	498.9	1183	2.2	1.6	3.8	14.7	13.9	13.9	0.38
★★	Tata ELSS	45.2	4091	1.8	0.8	8.9	16.6	14.6	14.2	0.38
★★	Union ELSS Tax Saver	63.4	772	2.4	1.4	6.2	14.8	13.9	13.0	0.36
★★	Edelweiss Long Term Equity	112.4	395	2.3	0.7	9.9	16.9	14.0	12.6	0.36
★★	HSBC ELSS Tax saver	134.5	3561	1.9	1.2	8.4	19.5	14.8	14.0	0.35
★★	Invesco India ELSS Tax Saver	117.3	2293	2.0	0.9	-0.2	15.4	11.9	13.0	0.26
★★	Nippon Ind ELSS Tax Saver	130.2	13422	1.7	1.0	7.4	18.4	15.9	11.5	0.43
★★	PGIM India ELSS Tax Saver	32.9	638	2.3	0.8	-0.9	10.4	11.9	12.7	0.31
★★	UTI ELSS Tax Saver	199.1	3175	1.9	1.0	2.3	13.4	11.2	12.2	0.26
★	Aditya Birla SL ELSS Tax Saver	60.5	33117	1.7	1.0	8.8	15.9	9.7	11.0	0.22
★	Axis ELSS Tax Saver	93.3	29076	1.6	0.8	1.5	14.0	9.0	12.1	0.17
★	LIC MF ELSS Tax Saver	144.7	915	2.2	1.1	-1.8	13.9	12.2	12.3	0.31
-	Groww ELSS Tax Saver	18.9	46	2.4	0.9	3.6	12.5	10.9	-	0.25
-	Shriram ELSS Tax Saver	20.5	42	2.3	0.7	1.2	10.6	9.4	-	0.18
-	Taurus ELSS Tax Saver	177.2	64	2.5	2.2	0.6	14.2	13.1	13.3	0.37
EQUITY - CONTRA FUNDS										
-	Invesco India Contra	129.9	17664	1.7	0.5	2.8	19.0	15.9	15.6	0.41
-	Kotak Contra	149.5	4679	1.9	0.6	7.5	19.6	16.7	16.2	0.46
-	SBI Contra	374.8	43754	1.5	0.8	3.2	17.3	19.8	16.2	0.66
EQUITY - DIVIDEND YIELD FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Dividend Yield Equity	53.2	5912	1.8	0.6	6.3	21.8	21.7	16.4	0.72
★★★★	Franklin Ind Dividend Yield	137.3	2141	2.1	1.3	3.4	15.5	16.5	15.3	0.59
★★★★	LIC MF Dividend Yield	30.3	583	2.0	0.8	5.8	21.2	16.6	-	0.43
★★★	UTI Dividend Yield	177.0	3497	2.0	1.5	7.3	20.1	15.9	14.5	0.48
★★	Aditya Birla SL Dividend Yield	460.1	1339	2.2	1.4	11.2	19.4	18.1	13.5	0.52
★	Sundaram Dividend Yield	154.5	810	2.3	1.1	3.8	15.7	13.7	14.9	0.42
EQUITY - THEMATIC - CONSUMPTION FUNDS										
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Consumption	183.6	2186	2.0	0.7	-4.4	13.7	15.6	13.2	0.42
★★★★	Baroda BNPPI India Consumption	29.6	1301	2.1	0.7	-3.5	13.9	12.9	-	0.32
★★★★	Canara Robeco Consumer Trends	103.4	1075	2.1	0.9	-1.0	14.4	13.6	15.7	0.33
★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Consumption	202.8	5478	1.8	0.8	-1.4	13.3	13.0	14.3	0.32
★★★★	Mirae Asset Great Consumer	88.3	4018	1.9	0.4	1.1	14.8	14.5	15.5	0.36
★★★★	SBI Consumption Opport	290.0	2644	2.0	1.0	-5.0	12.3	15.7	14.4	0.41
★★★★	Tata India Consumer	43.2	2261	2.0	0.8	2.0	17.6	14.8	16.0	0.35
★★	Sundaram Consumption	89.1	1294	2.2	1.2	-4.6	13.6	12.8	12.6	0.31
★★	UTI India Consumer	55.2	609	2.5	1.6	0.6	13.7	11.7	11.4	0.26
★	Mahli Manu Consumption	21.2	456	2.4	0.8	-1.5	13.4	12.7	-	0.32
EQUITY - SECTOR - BANKING FUNDS										
★★★★★	Sundaram Fin Serv Oppor	107.2	1439	2.1	0.8	5.4	17.5	15.8	15.4	0.37
★★★★	Invesco India Fin Serv	144.9	1480	2.1	0.8	12.2	21.1	17.3	16.2	0.39
★★★★	Nippon Ind Banking & Financial Serv	640.6	6721	1.9	1.0	6.2	17.4	17.9	14.9	0.42
★★★	Aditya Birla SL Bank & Fin Serv	62.2	3155	2.0	1.0	6.3	15.9	14.2	14.0	0.30
★★★	ICICI Pru Banking & Fin Serv	131.2	9367	1.8	1.1	2.4	13.8	13.5	14.6	0.31
★★★	SBI Banking & Fin Serv	44.2	9380	1.8	0.7	10.4	20.0	15.2	16.9	0.35
★★	Tata Banking and Fin Serv	43.7	2743	1.9	0.6	5.4	16.3	13.9	15.6	0.32
★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Bank&Fin Serv	48.2	346	2.4	0.8	4.1	16.0	12.9	13.1	0.27
★★	UTI Banking and Fin Serv	193.1	1213	2.2	1.1	5.3	15.7	14.0	12.5	0.31
★	LIC MF Banking & Fin Serv	21.4	239	2.5	1.2	7.8	11.8	12.1	10.2	0.26
-	Taurus Banking & Fin Serv	53.9	10	2.6	2.5	2.9	12.3	12.4	13.6	0.26
EQUITY - SECTOR - IT FUNDS										
★★★★★	SBI Technology Opport	194.1	4027	1.9	0.9	1.2	13.3	11.8	15.4	0.28
★★★★	ICICI Pru Technology	177.8	12575	1.8	1.0	-1.0	12.2	9.9	15.6	0.21
★★★	Franklin Ind Technology	460.7	1556	2.1	1.1	0.7	17.2	10.1	14.8	0.22
★★	Aditya Birla SL Digital India	150.9	3590	1.9	0.8	-0.5	10.5	8.8	15.4	0.17
★	Tata Digital India	41.1	9239	1.7	0.6	-2.7	11.2	9.2	14.8	0.19
EQUITY - SECTOR - PHARMA FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru P.H.D	38.8	6293	1.9	1.1	6.1	26.5	15.9	-	0.56
★★★★	DSP Healthcare	38.1	2892	1.9	0.6	2.5	21.3	13.4	-	0.42
★★★	Mirae Asset Healthcare	39.1	2758	1.9	0.5	7.9	23.3	13.2	-	0.47
★★★	Nippon Ind Pharma	504.7	7994	1.8	0.9	3.6	21.9	13.5	14.2	0.46
★★★	SBI Healthcare Opport	430.6	4064	1.9	0.9	4.2	24.4	15.8	12.0	0.57
★★	Tata India Pharma & Healthcare	29.4	1229	2.2	0.7	1.6	21.9	13.4	11.9	0.45
★	UTI Healthcare	285.4	1056	2.3	1.3	6.5	24.5	14.0	12.5	0.45
-	LIC MF Healthcare	28.4	78	2.4	0.6	0.8	20.1	10.5	-	0.32
HYBRID - AGGRESSIVE HYBRID FUNDS										
★★★★★	BOI AXA Mid & Small Cap Eq&Debt	39.7	1282	2.0	0.7	12.9	20.0	17.7	-	0.46
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Equity & Debt	403.9	46700	1.5	0.9	7.4	18.6	18.8	16.0	0.79
★★★★	Quant Aggressive Hybrid	435.4	1809	2.1	0.8	9.7	14.1	14.8	15.6	0.46
★★★★	Baroda BNP Pari Aggressive Hybrid	27.7	1146	2.1	0.5	5.0	13.8	12.0	-	0.38
★★★★	Edelweiss Aggressive Hybrid	63.4	3309	1.9	0.4	5.5	15.8	14.7	12.7	0.54
★★★★	JM Aggressive Hybrid	116.1	652	2.4	0.9	0.5	17.3	14.9	12.3	0.44
★★★★	Kotak Aggressive Hybrid	63.3	7812	1.7	0.5	9.6	15.1	13.3	13.1	0.43
★★★★	UTI Aggressive Hybrid	405.3	6115	1.9	1.2	4.9	15.6	14.5	12.5	0.54
★★★	Bandhan Aggressive Hybrid	26.7	1676	2.1	0.6	10.3	16.1	13.4	-	0.42
★★★	Canara Robeco Equity Hybrid	361.3	10253	1.7	0.6	5.9	13.5	11.5	12.6	0.37
★★★	DSP Aggressive Hybrid	348.1	10883	1.7	0.7	0.3	14.5	11.5	12.2	0.46
★★★	Franklin Ind Aggressive Hybrid	266.0	2164	2.1	0.9	2.5	13.8	12.0	11.4	0.36

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest		Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
		NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Regular	Direct	1 Month	3Month	6Month	1 Year	
						*Ann	*Ann	*Ann	CAGR	
CASH FUNDS										
LIQUID FUNDS										
-	360 ONE Liquid	2106.9	1177	0.3	0.2	8.8	6.8	6.2	6.1	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Liquid	441.6	43022	0.4	0.2	9.1	7.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	Axis Liquid	3051.9	30188	0.2	0.1	9.2	7.1	6.4	6.3	-
-	Bandhan Liquid	3307.7	12083	0.2	0.1	9.0	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	Bank of India Liquid	3156.4	1611	0.1	0.1	8.8	7.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3148.7	8599	0.3	0.1	8.9	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	Canara Robeco Liquid	3298.3	4858	0.2	0.1	9.1	7.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	DSP Liquidity	3912.7	16866	0.2	0.1	9.1	7.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	Edelweiss Liquid	3504.7	8877	0.1	0.0	9.1	7.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	Groww Liquid	2649.5	162	0.2	0.1	8.7	6.9	6.4	6.3	-
-	HDFC Liquid	5375.9	53982	0.3	0.2	9.1	7.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	HSBC Liquid	2731.4	13434	0.2	0.1	9.0	7.0	6.3	6.3	-
-	ICICI Pru Liquid	405.4	42888	0.3	0.2	8.9	6.8	6.3	6.2	-
-	Invesco India Liquid	3765.9	11723	0.2	0.2	9.1	7.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	ITI Liquid	1425.3	58	0.3	0.1	8.5	6.6	6.1	6.1	-
-	JM Liquid	74.7	2567	0.3	0.2	8.5	6.8	6.2	6.2	-
-	Kotak Liquid	5536.3	33309	0.3	0.2	9.0	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	LIC MF Liquid	4951.9	11106	0.2	0.1	9.1	7.0	6.4	6.2	-
-	Mahi Manu Liquid	1783.0	1012	0.3	0.2	8.8	7.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	Mirae Asset Liquid	2872.3	10562	0.2	0.1	8.8	6.9	6.3	6.2	-
-	Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.4	1017	0.4	0.2	7.8	6.3	5.9	5.8	-
-	Navi Liquid	29.7	62	0.2	0.2	7.1	5.9	5.7	5.8	-
-	Nippon Ind Liquid	6685.9	25756	0.4	0.2	9.1	7.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	Parag Parikh Liquid	1519.2	5171	0.2	0.1	9.0	7.0	6.3	6.2	-
-	PGIM India Liquid	356.7	478	0.2	0.1	9.1	7.0	6.4	6.3	5.20
-	Quant Liquid	43.2	1418	0.5	0.2	6.8	6.1	5.8	5.9	-
-	Quantum Liquid	36.6	510	0.3	0.2	7.1	6.1	5.8	5.8	-
-	SBI Liquid	4281.0	57891	0.3	0.2	9.1	7.0	6.3	6.2	-
-	Sundaram Liquid	2414.3	5175	0.4	0.1	8.9	6.8	6.2	6.1	-
-	Tata Liquid	4315.3	22316	0.3	0.2	8.9	6.9	6.4	6.3	-
-	Union Liquid	2636.6	5756	0.2	0.1	8.9	6.9	6.4	6.3	-
-	UTI Liquid	4495.8	19763	0.3	0.2	9.1	7.0	6.4	6.3	-
-	WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1472.5	592	0.3	0.2	8.9	6.9	6.3	6.2	-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.8	25065	1.0	0.3	6.4	6.1	6.0	5.9	-
-	Axis Arbitrage	19.6	9023	1.0	0.3	6.8	6.3	6.1	5.9	-
-	Bandhan Arbitrage	33.9	7970	1.1	0.3	6.3	6.0	5.8	5.7	-
-	Bank of India Arbitrage	14.4	45	0.9	0.4	5.1	5.5	5.7	5.5	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.8	1276	1.1	0.3	5.6	5.7	5.6	5.7	-
-	DSP Arbitrage	15.6	6376	0.9	0.3	6.4	6.1	5.9	5.8	-
-	Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.3	14414	1.1	0.4	6.5	6.1	6.0	5.9	-
-	HDFC Arbitrage	32.1	23777	0.9	0.4	6.4	6.2	6.1	5.9	-
-	HSBC Arbitrage	19.9	2526	0.9	0.3	6.7	6.5	6.2	5.9	-
-	ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	36.0	31342	0.9	0.4	6.7	6.4	6.2	6.0	-
-	Invesco India Arbitrage	33.5	26370	1.1	0.4	6.3	6.2	6.2	6.0	-
-	ITI Arbitrage	13.6	73	0.9	0.2	6.0	6.7	6.3	6.1	-
-	JM Arbitrage	34.1	353	1.1	0.4	5.2	5.6	5.7	5.5	-
-	Kotak Arbitrage	39.3	67117	1.0	0.4	6.6	6.4	6.2	6.0	-
-	LIC MF Arbitrage	14.5	220	1.0	0.3	5.8	6.1	5.9	5.7	-
-	Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.9	106	1.1	0.4	5.1	5.4	5.5	5.2	-
-	Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.6	3474	0.9	0.1	5.7	5.9	5.9	5.7	-
-	Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.8	15788	1.0	0.3	6.0	6.0	6.0	5.8	0.80
-	PGIM India Arbitrage	19.2	100	1.0	0.4	6.0	6.0	5.7	5.4	-
-	SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.4	41059	0.9	0.4	6.4	6.2	6.1	6.1	-
-	Sundaram Arbitrage	15.1	412	1.0	0.3	5.5	6.1	6.0	5.8	-
-	Tata Arbitrage	15.1	20686	1.1	0.3	6.6	6.2	6.1	6.0	-
-	Union Arbitrage	14.7	241	1.0	0.4	6.4	5.9	5.8	5.7	-
-	UTI Arbitrage	36.7	10500	0.8	0.3	6.5	6.2	6.2	6.0	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year	2 Year	3 Year	5 Year	
						CAGR	CAGR	CAGR	CAGR	
DEBT FUNDS										
DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
*****	Aditya Birla SL Savings	576.2	19348	0.6	0.3	6.7	7.3	7.3	6.4	8.68
*****	Baroda BNP Pari Ultra Short Dur	1619.7	705	0.5	0.3	6.5	7.0	7.1	6.2	-
*****	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4226.5	9512	1.1	0.4	6.3	6.8	6.8	6.7	24.37
*****	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.0	3528	0.5	0.3	6.4	7.0	7.0	6.0	-
*****	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.1	13619	0.8	0.4	6.5	7.0	7.1	6.1	11.70
*****	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1374.2	1640	0.4	0.1	6.5	7.1	7.2	6.2	1.22
*****	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4437.1	3130	1.0	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.8	6.3	8.56
*****	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.4	3958	1.2	0.4	6.0	6.6	6.6	5.7	10.59
*****	DSP Ultra Short	3565.8	3560	1.0	0.3	6.0	6.6	6.7	5.6	8.42
*****	HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.9	16037	0.7	0.4	6.3	6.9	7.0	6.0	4.28
*****	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1421.8	2470	0.3	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.1	6.1	-
*****	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2827.7	963	0.8	0.2	6.2	6.8	6.9	5.8	12.87
*****	Kotak Savings	44.9	14989	0.8	0.4	6.2	6.8	6.8	5.9	7.59
*****	Mahindra Man Ultra Short Duration	1443.1	194	0.7	0.3	6.3	6.9	6.9	5.9	3.87
*****	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6272.7	11847	0.6	0.4	6.4	7.0	7.0	6.0	9.47
*****	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1423.5	586	1.0	0.5	5.9	6.4	6.5	5.6	-
*****	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3310.5	117	0.9	0.3	6.0	6.5	6.4	5.6	9.44
*****	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1381.8	187	1.2	0.2	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.5	2.88
*****	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.6	161	0.9	0.4	5.7	6.3	6.5	5.6	-
*****	Tata Ultra Short Term	14.9	3955	1.2	0.3	6.1	6.6	6.6	5.6	8.31
*****	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3974.6	483	1.0	0.4	6.0	6.5	6.5	5.4	-
*****	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.2	411	1.0	0.2	5.3	5.6	5.7	4.8	-
*****	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2796.2	1454	1.4	0.2	5.3	5.9	6.0	5.1	2.13
DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS										

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Savings	571.9	26665	0.6	0.4	6.7	7.4	7.6	6.5	6.87
*****	UTI Low Duration	3726.1	2246	0.4	0.3	6.5	7.3	7.3	7.3	7.56
*****	Axis Treasury Advantage	3248.0	5455	0.7	0.3	6.5	7.2	7.2	6.2	8.20
*****	DSP Low Duration	20.8	4669	0.6	0.3	6.1	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
*****	HDFC Low Duration	60.5	22104	1.1	0.5	6.1	6.9	7.0	6.0	12.55
*****	HSBC Low Duration	30.1	981	0.9	0.4	7.6	7.7	7.6	6.2	9.83
*****	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	685.9	10865	1.2	0.4	5.9	6.7	6.7	5.8	12.11
*****	Bandhan Low Duration	40.4	5723	0.7	0.3	6.1	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
*****	Canara Robeco Savings	44.2	1295	0.5	0.2	6.3	7.0	7.1	5.9	-
*****	Invesco India Low Duration	3964.7	1659	0.7	0.3	6.2	7.0	7.0	5.9	6.15
*****	JM Low Duration	38.8	212	0.9	0.4	6.1	6.9	6.9	5.8	5.86
*****	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3920.6	8768	1.1	0.4	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.0	8.84
*****	SBI Low Duration	3652.2	13583	0.9	0.4	5.9	6.8	6.8	5.8	3.90
*****	Tata Treasury Advantage	4119.2	2460	0.6	0.3	6.2	7.0	7.0	6.0	3.03
*****	Kotak Low Duration	3495.7	15257	1.2	0.4	6.0	6.8	6.8	5.8	12.08
*****	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1709.8	555	1.1	0.3	6.0	6.7	6.8	5.7	13.73
*****	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2363.3	2333	0.8	0.2	6.0	6.9	6.9	5.8	3.86
*****	Sundaram Low Duration	3610.1	436	1.2	0.4	5.7	6.7	6.6	5.7	2.98
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	41.9	260	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.7	6.7	5.7	1.94
*****	LIC MF Low Duration	41.4	1830	0.4	0.3	5.9	6.7	6.7	5.7	2.85

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Money Market	4364.4	19420	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.4	6.4	-
*****	UTI Money Market	3244.1	18344	0.2	0.1	6.6	7.3	7.4	6.4	-
*****	Aditya Birla SL Money Manager	389.1	28780	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.4	6.4	-
*****	Axis Money Market	1505.5	20349	0.3	0.2	6.6	7.3	7.4	6.4	-
*****	ICICI Pru Money Market	399.1	31750	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.3	7.4	6.3	-
*****	Kotak Money Market	4722.9	32331	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Money Market	1449.0	4365	0.4	0.2	6.5	7.1	7.1	5.9	-
*****	Franklin Ind Money Market	52.8	3959	0.3	0.1	6.5	7.3	7.3	6.2	-
*****	HDFC Money Market	6011.1	28188	0.5	0.2	6.5	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
*****	PGIM India Money Market	1392.5	152	0.5	0.2	6.3	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
*****	Sundaram Money Market	15.8	1943	0.3	0.2	6.5	7.1	7.2	6.1	-
*****	Tata Money Market	4966.8	32382	0.4	0.2	6.6	7.2	7.4	6.4	-
*****	DSP Savings	55.3	8947	0.4	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.1	6.0	-
*****	HSBC Money Market	27.7	5970	0.3	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.1	5.9	-

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
★★★★	Invesco India Money Market	3198.3	7154	0.4	0.2	6.3	7.0	7.1	6.0	-
★★★★	SBI Savings	43.5	34892	0.6	0.3	6.2	6.9	6.9	5.9	-
★★★★	Bandhan Money Market	42.4	13437	0.4	0.1	6.5	7.1	7.0	5.8	-
★★★★	Edelweiss Money Market	29.8	2508	0.8	0.1	6.0	6.6	6.7	5.5	-
DEBT - SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
★★★★★	ICICI Pru Short Term	63.0	20688	1.1	0.5	6.0	7.5	7.5	6.5	10.50
★★★★★	UTI Short Duration	33.0	2359	0.8	0.4	5.2	7.0	7.1	7.0	9.41
★★★★★	Aditya Birla SL Short Term	49.6	6501	1.0	0.4	5.4	7.3	7.1	6.2	14.38
★★★★★	Axis Short Duration	32.3	8342	0.9	0.4	5.9	7.6	7.3	6.2	9.99
★★★★★	HDFC Short Term Debt	33.4	14728	0.7	0.4	5.6	7.5	7.4	6.3	9.59
★★★★★	Nippon Ind Short Duration	55.0	6632	1.0	0.4	5.5	7.4	7.2	6.1	8.51
★★★★★	Bandhan Short Duration	59.6	8612	0.8	0.3	5.6	7.5	7.2	5.9	-
★★★★	Baroda BNP Paribas Short Duration	30.4	280	1.1	0.4	5.1	7.1	6.9	5.8	1.80
★★★★	Kotak Short Duration	27.6	3799	0.7	0.3	5.4	7.3	6.9	5.7	-
★★★★	HSBC Bond Short Term	54.1	15582	1.1	0.4	4.9	7.0	6.9	5.8	-
★★★★	Mirae Asset Short Duration	16.3	593	1.1	0.2	4.6	6.8	6.6	5.5	-
★★★★	SBI Short Term Debt	33.4	14580	0.9	0.4	5.4	7.2	7.0	5.9	6.58
★★★★	Sundaram Short Duration	46.1	1900	0.7	0.3	5.3	7.2	7.0	6.0	2.62
★★★★	Canara Robeco Short Duration	26.6	357	1.0	0.3	5.0	6.7	6.5	5.4	-
★★★★	DSP Short Term	48.3	2903	0.9	0.4	4.9	6.9	6.8	5.6	-
★★★★	Invesco India Short Duration	3702.1	712	1.1	0.4	5.1	7.0	6.8	5.5	3.91
★★★★	Tata Short Term Bond	49.6	2785	1.2	0.3	4.5	6.6	6.5	5.5	-
★★★★	Groww Short Term	2161.3	88	1.1	0.4	5.1	6.7	6.2	5.0	-
★★★★	LIC MF Short Duration	15.1	188	1.2	0.4	4.8	6.8	6.6	5.2	5.69
★★★★	- Bank of India Short Term Income	27.8	278	1.0	0.5	5.0	7.6	7.0	10.1	2.89
★★★★	- Mahi Manu Short Duration	13.3	88	1.3	0.4	5.2	7.0	6.8	5.6	13.56

YES Bank standalone net surges 45% on rise in net interest income

STRONG BASE. The growth comes on the back of lower provisions as the asset quality improved

Our Bureau
Mumbai

YES Bank reported a 45 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) jump in fourth quarter (Q4FY26) standalone net profit at ₹1,068 crore against ₹738 crore on the back of healthy growth in net interest income and decline in loan loss provisions even as it showed further improvement in asset quality.

Non-Interest Income, including fee-based income, treasury income and recovery in written-off accounts, declined a shade to ₹1,730 crore from ₹1,739 crore in the year ago quarter.

Loan loss provisions declined about 41 per cent y-o-y to ₹188 crore (₹318 crore).

In his first media interac-

tion after taking over as MD and CEO on April 6, Vinay Tonse observed that the bank operates on a stronger base with resilient asset quality, a more granular franchise, a strengthened deposit engine, and renewed stakeholder confidence supported by strong shareholders such as Japan's Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corporation (SMBC), continuing support from State Bank of India and Advent International.

SMBC SUPPORT

“Our ongoing collaboration with SMBC provides helpful strategic support, particularly in corporate and cross-border banking,” he said.

Net interest margin (NIM) improved to 2.70 per cent from 2.50 per cent in Q4FY25.

Q4 results			
	Q4 FY25	Q4 FY26	% change
Net profit	738	1,068	44.7
Interest earned	7,616	7,651	
Interest expended	5,340	5,013	
Net interest income	2,276	2,638	15.9
Other income	1,739	1,730	-0.5
Operating profit	1,314	1,618	23.1
NPA Prov	318	188	-40.9
Deposits	2,84,525	3,18,969	12.1
Advances	2,46,188	2,73,445	11.1

Tonse said the improvement in NIM was driven by front-loaded repricing of deposits, which benefited the Bank through the year, continued traction in CASA (current account, savings account) deposits, and also reduction in high-cost borrowings and RIDF (Rural Infrastructure Develop-

ment Fund)-related mandated deposits.

ASSET QUALITY

Asset quality continued to strengthen, with gross NPAs (non-performing assets) and net NPAs declining to 1.3 per cent (from 1.5 per cent as on December-end 2025) and 0.2 per cent

(0.3 per cent), respectively. Provision CoverageRatio was at 81.9 per cent.

“These (asset quality ratios) are the best levels in the last 24 quarters, supported by disciplined underwriting, improved collections, and lower slippages across product segments,” Tonse said.

Recoveries and upgrades for FY26 were ₹4,795 crore, including ₹1,547 crore on security receipts (SRs). The Bank remains on track to deliver the SR recoveries of ₹800 to 1,000 crore in FY27.

Further, total deposits crossed the ₹3 lakh crore milestone, with CASA balances crossing the milestone of ₹1 lakh crore.

CASA grew 14.9 per cent year-on-year, and the CASA ratio improved to 35.1 per cent, (34.3 per cent in Q4FY25)

Defeated Delimitation Bill to defend ‘idea of India’, says Rahul Gandhi

Press Trust of India
Chennai

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Saturday said the opposition parties defeated the Delimitation Bill in the Parliament on Friday to defend the “idea of India,” as he mounted an attack against the RSS-BJP.

Addressing a poll rally at Ponneri, near here, his first campaign for the April 23 Assembly elections in Tamil Nadu, Gandhi said the BJP-led government at the Centre had brought a new Bill on April 16, and said they were trying to pass the women’s reservation Bill, which he said was adopted in 2023.

WEAKENING SOUTH

“In the so-called women’s reservation Bill, delimitation was hidden. The idea was to reduce Tamil Nadu’s representation in the Union of India... the delimitation move by the BJP was to weaken the strength of southern, small,



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi MOORTHY M

and north-eastern States,” he alleged.

Gandhi said that India that is Bharat, is a union of states, and every single State should have a voice, be free to express itself, and protect its tradition.

At the rally he said, “election is first an ideological battle, second, political fight; it is coercion versus consensus.” Slamming the BJP, Gandhi alleged that the party wanted an India “where two or three companies control everything.” It wanted to “crush the ideas of rationalist leader EV Ramasamy Periyar, your model of government, and destroy the idea of social justice,” he alleged and

appealed to the people to “stop this assault by RSS-BJP.” He also lashed out at BJP ally in TN, the AIADMK, saying it was not the same party that strived for the people of the State.

“When you see the AIADMK flag, its leaders, remember they are fully controlled by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and (Union Home Minister) Amit Shah because of their corruption. New AIADMK is just a mask; the mask hiding BJP,” he alleged.

AIADMK, ONLY A SHELL

Playing the Dravidian party, which leads the NDA in Tamil Nadu, the Congress leader said the AIADMK was “now a hollow shell.” It had a great tradition of defending the people of Tamil Nadu like the DMK, but that “AIADMK died long back”, he said.

He also accused the AIADMK of allowing the BJP to rule the State from Delhi, and take the orders from Amit Shah and Modi.

MeitY constitutes advisory panel for AI Governance Group

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) on Saturday constituted the Technology and Policy Expert Committee (TPEC), a standing expert advisory body to support the functioning of the recently constituted AI Governance and Economic Group (AIGEG).

The TPEC will be chaired by the MeitY Secretary and its members include IIT Madras professor B Ravindran, IIT Gandhinagar



director Rajat Moona, and representatives from Nasscom, DSCI and MAIT.

The Committee, among other duties, will provide expertise to the AIGEG in relation to AI policy and governance. It will also identify potential risks and regulatory gaps, and track global developments in the field.

SEC, Adanis ask US court for time to file submissions

Press Trust of India
New York

The US Securities and Exchange Commission and Gautam and Sagar Adani have jointly requested a US court for more time to file key submissions in a civil securities case, proposing a revised schedule for motions and responses.

In a filing before the US District Court for the Eastern District of New York, the parties said they had conferred in line with the court’s April 7 directive and agreed

on a new timeline, which has been submitted for approval to the court.

The SEC had sued Adani Group founder Gautam Adani and his nephew, Sagar, in November 2024, alleging they had misled investors by failing to disclose an alleged bribery scheme tied to Indian officials, framing the case under US securities laws. Under the proposed schedule, the defendant’s (Adanis) motion to dismiss would be due by June 8, the SEC’s amended complaint or opposition by August 7, and the defendants’ reply by September 21.

Cabinet extends PM Gram Sadak Yojana till March 2028

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Union Cabinet on Saturday approved continuation of the third phase of the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY-III) beyond March 2025 up to March 2028. “The revised outlay of the scheme will be ₹83,977 crore (as against ₹80,250 crore),” an official statement said. The scheme involves consolidation of ‘through routes’ and ‘major rural links’ connecting habitations to Gramin Agricultural Markets (GRAMs), higher secondary schools and hospitals.

The statement said that under the third phase, there will be extension of timeline till March 2028 for completion of roads and bridges in plains and roads in hilly areas. However, for completion of bridges in hilly area, the revised timeline will be till March 2029. Works sanctioned before March 31, 2025, but un-awarded till now may be taken up for tender/award.

“The extension of the timeline of PMGSY-III will enable the full realisation of its intended socio-economic



ADJUSTED DEADLINE. For completion of bridges in hilly area, the revised timeline will be till March 2029 PTI

benefits by ensuring completion of targeted upgradation of rural roads,” the statement said.

Further, it will significantly boost the rural economy and trade by enhancing market access for agricultural and non-farm products, reducing transportation time and costs, and thereby improving rural incomes.

2 RAILWAY PROJECTS

Improved connectivity will facilitate better access to education and healthcare institutions, ensuring timely delivery of essential services, particularly in remote and

underserved areas, it said.

The Cabinet also approved two multitracking projects covering 15 districts across Uttar Pradesh and Andhra Pradesh, increasing the existing network of the Railways by about 601 km. The total estimated cost of the projects is ₹24,815 crore to be completed up to 2030-31, another official statement said.

The first project proposes to lay the third and fourth line between Ghaziabad and Sitapur in Uttar Pradesh with a total length of 403 km. This section is an existing double line one forming a key part of the Delhi- Guwa-

hati High Density Network. The existing line capacity utilisation of the section is up to 168 per cent and is projected to be up to 207 per cent in case the project is not taken up. The project route passes through major industrial centres — Ghaziabad (machinery, electronics, pharmaceuticals), Moradabad (brassware and handicrafts), Bareilly (furniture, textiles, engineering), Shahjahanpur (carpets and cement-related industries) and Roza (thermal power plant).

The second project is to lay the third and fourth lines between Rajahmundry (Nidadavolu) and Visakhapatnam (Duvvada). This section

forms part of the Howrah-Chennai High Density Network (HDN).

The line traverses East Godavari, Konaseema, Kakinada, Anakapalle and Vishakapatnam districts of Andhra Pradesh. The line capacity utilisation of the section has already reached up to 130 per cent, leading to frequent congestion and operational delays. The line capacity is expected to increase further due to proposed expansion of ports and industries in the region.

The proposed section will also boost tourism by improving access to key destinations such as Annavaram, Antarvedi and Draksharam etc.

DA/DR hiked

After a long gap, the Dearness Allowance (DA) and Dearness Relief (DR) for serving and retired Central government employees was raised, respectively, by 2 per cent. According to a decision by the Union Cabinet, DA/DR will now be 60 per cent of the basic pay or basic pension.

The new rates will be effective from January 1, 2026, and will benefit about 50.46 lakh Central government employees and 68.27 lakh pensioners. The combined impact on the exchequer on account of increase in both DA and DR would be over ₹6,700 crore annually.